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RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

DEMOGRAPHIC AND SETTLEMENT HISTORY OF THE SOVIET UNION UNDER LENIN AND STALIN.

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1922AD - 1953AD).

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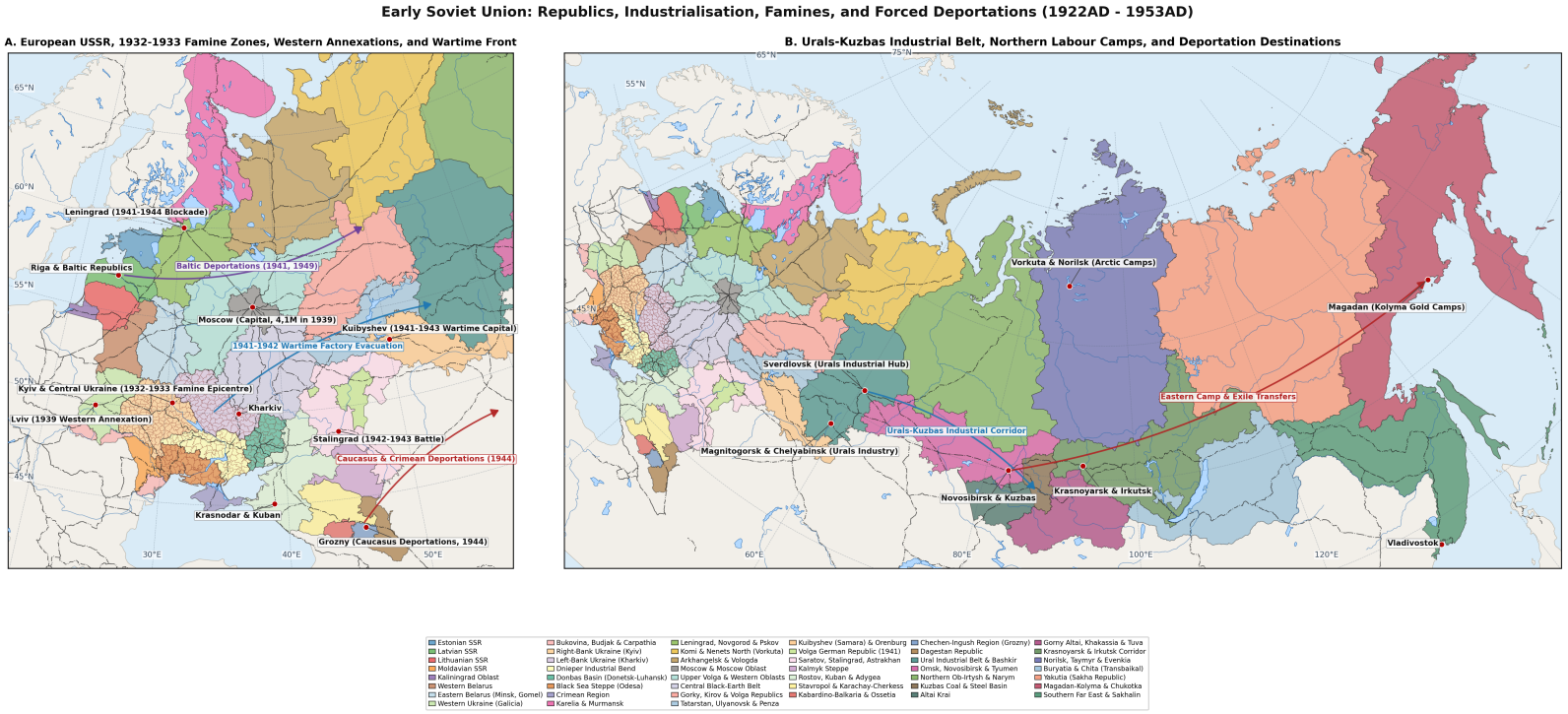


Figure 1. Administrative regions, collectivisation famines, wartime evacuations, and forced deportations across the Soviet Union (1926AD - 1953AD).

Population Estimates, Censuses, and the 45 Stalin-Era Regions (1926AD - 1953AD)

Between the First All-Union Census of 17 December 1926AD and the death of Joseph Stalin on 5 March 1953AD, the territories of the Russian SFSR (including Kaliningrad Oblast from 1945AD and the Karelo-Finnish SSR from 1940AD to 1956AD), the Ukrainian SSR, the Byelorussian SSR, the Estonian, Latvian, and Lithuanian SSRs, and the Moldavian SSR experienced the most violent demographic convulsions, forced population movements, and ethno-territorial restructurings in modern Eurasian history [1][2][3][4]. Over twenty-seven years, the population of these forty-five regions was reshaped by seven interlocking shocks.

Forced Collectivisation and Dekulakisation (1929-1933AD): The expropriation and freight-train exile of 1 803 392 peasants (381 026 families in 1930-1931AD, rising to ~2,1M by 1933AD) as special settlers (spetspereselentsy) into northern, Ural, and Siberian forestry, mining, and taiga clearings (archived PDF;

archived PDF) [5][6][7].

The 1932-1933AD Man-Made Famines (Holodomor in Ukraine, MASSR, Kuban, and Volga): Direct famine mortality of 3,5M to 3,94M in the Ukrainian SSR and Moldavian ASSR (4,53M including lost births) and ~2,63M across the Russian SFSR (Kuban, Don, Lower and Middle Volga, Volga German ASSR, and Central Black-Earth Belt) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [8][9][10][11].

Pre-War Border Cleansings (1935-1938AD), the 1937AD Korean Deportation, and the 1937-1938AD Great Terror: NKVD expulsions of Poles, Germans, and Ingrian Finns from western border zones, the total deportation of 171 781 Soviet Koreans from Primorye (Region 45) in autumn 1937AD, and the execution of ~681 692 persons during the 1937-1938AD Yezhovshchina and national operations [4][12][13].

Stalinist Five-Year-Plan Industrialisation and the Gulag Archipelago (1928-1953AD): The rural-to-urban transfer of >25M peasants into heavy-industrial metropolises (Regions 12, 13, 17, 20, 23-25, 34, 35, 37) alongside forced-labour colonisation of the Arctic, sub-Arctic, and Far East (Belbaltlag, Vorkutlag, Ukhtpechlag, Dmitlag, Siblag, Norillag, Ozerlag, Bamlag, and Dalstroy/Sevvostlag across Regions 16, 18, 20, 36, 37, 40-45) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [14][15][16].

The 1939-1940AD Western Annexations (Baltic SSRs, Bessarabia, Western Belarus, Western Ukraine, and Finnish Karelia): Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact occupation of Western Belarus (Region 6), Galicia-Volhynia (Region 8), Finnish Karelia (Region 16), Bessarabia/Northern Bukovina (Regions 4 and 9), and the Estonian, Latvian, and Lithuanian SSRs (Regions 1-3), accompanied by the 1939-1941AD Umsiedlung of ~215k Baltic and Bessarabian Germans and the June 1941AD NKVD deportations (archived PDF; archived PDF) [17][18][19][20].

The Great Patriotic War (1941-1945AD), the Holocaust, and Total Ethnic Deportations (1941-1944AD): Wartime losses of 26,6M to 27,0M across the USSR, the Holocaust of ~2,5M to 2,7M Jews across the occupied Soviet republics (including Ponary, Ninth Fort, Rumbula, Minsk, Babyn Yar, and Transnistria), the 872-day Siege of Leningrad (Region 17), eastward factory/civilian evacuation, and the liquidation of the Volga German ASSR (Region 26), Karachay AO (Region 30), Kalmyk ASSR (Region 28), Chechen-Ingush ASSR (Region 32), Balkar districts (Region 31), and Crimean ASSR (Region 15) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [21][22][23][24].

Post-War Expulsions, the 1946-1947AD Famine, and 1948-1951AD Borderland Deportations (Vesna, Priboi, Yug, Osen): The total population replacement of Kaliningrad Oblast (Region 5) and South Sakhalin (Region 45), Polish-Ukrainian-Lithuanian population transfers, fierce anti-Soviet partisan wars in Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia, and Western Ukraine, the 1946-1947AD Soviet famine (peaking per capita in the Moldavian SSR, Region 4), and mass collectivisation deportations across the Baltic and Moldavian SSRs (archived PDF; archived PDF) [25][26][27][28].

Archival Census Benchmarks, Epoch Boundary Splicing, and Reconstructed 45-Region Totals (1926AD - 1953AD)

To eliminate anachronistic post-1991AD administrative boundaries and capture the exact territorial footprint of Stalinist demographic engineering, this synthesis partitions the European and Asian USSR (excluding Transcaucasia and Central Asia, which are modelled in their respective regional series) into 45 regions spanning 18 177 917 km2 across eleven benchmark years (1926, 1930, 1933, 1937, 1939, 1941, 1943, 1945, 1947, 1950, 1953) [1][2][29][30]:

17 December 1926AD First All-Union Census and Epoch Splicing (145 070k across the 45 regions): Published in 56 volumes under Vasiliy Mikhaylovsky (TsSU SSSR), the 1926AD census enumerated 147,03M across the interwar USSR (92,74M in the RSFSR, 29,02M in the UkSSR including 572k in the Moldavian ASSR, and 4,98M in the BSSR) [31]. Within our constant 1953AD outer envelope of 45 regions

(which excludes interwar Congress Poland and mainland Finland covered in the preceding 1917-1926AD epoch at 167 780k, while incorporating the 1926AD baselines of Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Bessarabia, Northern East Prussia/Kaliningrad, Galicia-Volhynia, Northern Bukovina, Transcarpathia, Finnish Viipuri/Karelia, Tannu-Tuva, and Southern Sakhalin), the 1926AD baseline stood at 145 070k: 5 620k across the three Baltic republics (1 115k in Estonia Region 1, 1 860k in Latvia Region 2, and 2 645k in Lithuania Region 3), 2 040k in Moldavia Region 4 (Bessarabia plus left-bank MASSR), 7 180k in Belarus Regions 6-7, 36 700k in Ukraine/Crimea Regions 8-15, and 93 530k in Russia/Karelia/Kaliningrad (1 120k in Northern East Prussia Region 5 and 92 410k across Regions 16-45). High late-NEP natural increase raised the 45-region total to a pre-famine peak of 153 848k in 1930AD.

The 1933AD Famine Trough (149 934k) and the Suppressed 6 January 1937AD Census (157 315k): Collectivisation and the 1932-1933AD famines reduced the 45-region total by -3 914k between 1930AD and 1933AD (149 934k: 5 874k in the Baltic states, 2 190k in Moldavia where MASSR famine losses were offset by interwar Romanian Bessarabian growth, 7 700k in Belarus, 35 350k in Ukraine/Crimea - a net collapse of -3 650k driven by -3 900k across Soviet Ukrainian Regions 10-14 - and 98 820k in Russia/Karelia/Kaliningrad) [8][10]. When the one-day de facto All-Union Census of 6 January 1937AD recorded only 162,04M across the USSR (~8M below Stalin's proclaimed target), the Sovnarkom declared the census "wrecked", executed or imprisoned its statistical leadership (I. A. Kraval, O. A. Kvitkin, M. V. Kurman, L. S. Brandgendler), and locked the returns in RGAE (Fond 1562, Opis 329) until 1989-1991AD (archived PDF) [29][32][33]. Across the 45 regions, the 1937AD population stood at 157 315k.

The 17 January 1939AD Census (166 199k) and June 1941AD Pre-Invasion Peak (172 579k): Declassified audits of the 1939AD census (170,56M official USSR total) by Andreev, Darsky, and Kharkova (1993, 1998) demonstrated a central pripiska (statistical inflation) of 1,7M to 2,9M and a secret redistribution of ~760k to 850k NKVD camp inmates from northern and Siberian Gulag regions (Regions 16, 18, 36, 37, 40-45) to rural districts of Ukraine and Kazakhstan to conceal both Gulag concentrations and 1933AD famine deficits (archived PDF; archived PDF) [1][30][34][35]. Harmonised across all 45 regions, total population reached 166 199k in 1939AD and peaked in June 1941AD at 172 579k (5 994k in the Baltic SSRs after the 1939-1941AD Baltic German Umsiedlung and 14 June 1941AD deportations, 2 470k in the Moldavian SSR, 8 800k in the Byelorussian SSR, 41 560k in the Ukrainian SSR including Crimea, and 113 755k in Russia/Karelia/East Prussia).

The 1943AD Wartime Midpoint (146 480k), 1945AD Post-War Trough (142 619k), 1947AD Famine (146 240k), and 1953AD Late Stalinist Splice (165 350k): Nazi/Romanian occupation, combat mortality, the Holocaust, urban sieges, wartime flight, and 1941-1944AD ethnic deportations depressed the 45-region total to 146 480k in 1943AD and 142 619k in 1945AD (-29 960k, or -17,4%, below June 1941AD: 4 894k in the Baltic SSRs, 2 080k in the Moldavian SSR, 180k in devastated Kaliningrad Oblast, 6 300k in Belarus, 30 150k in Ukraine/Crimea, and 99 015k across Regions 16-45) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [36][37]. Checked by the 1946-1947AD famine (146 240k in 1947AD, when the Moldavian SSR plunged to its 1 940k famine trough) and 1947-1951AD western deportations, post-war demobilisation and industrial reconstruction carried the 45 regions to 156 532k in 1950AD and 165 350k in March 1953AD (5 780k in the Baltic SSRs, 2 520k in the Moldavian SSR, 7 200k in the Byelorussian SSR, 35 480k in the Ukrainian SSR including Crimea, and 114 370k in the RSFSR including 540k in Kaliningrad and 1 120k in the Karelo-Finnish SSR), splicing identically at 165 350k with the subsequent post-Stalin (1953AD - 1991AD) epoch.

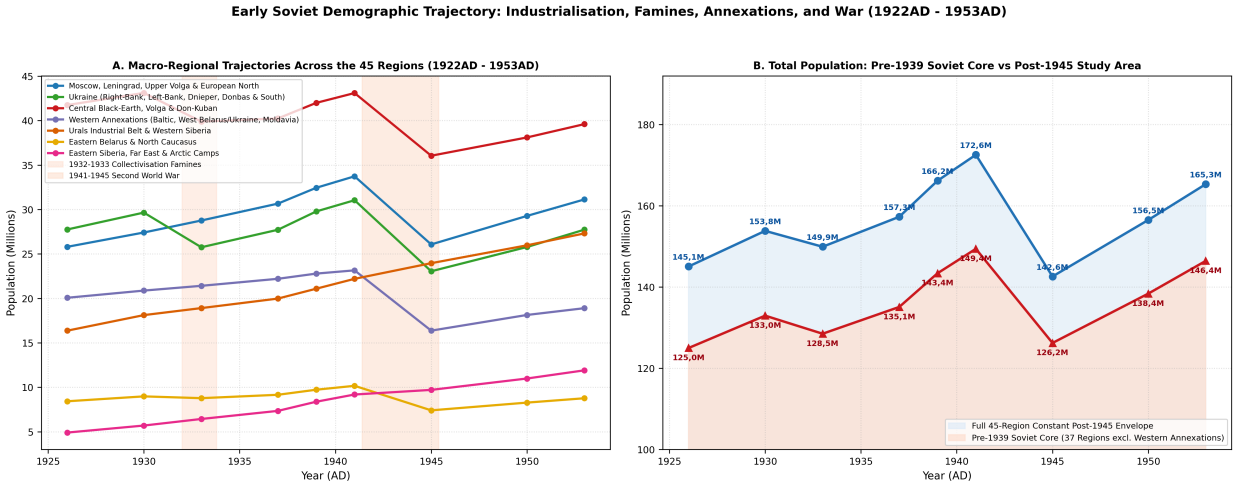


Figure 2. Regional and union-republic population trajectories across the forty-five Soviet demographic regions from 1926AD to 1953AD.

Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
1. Estonian SSR (1940 Occup., 1941/49 Priboi & Oil-Shale Inflow)	1 115k	1 118k	1 124k	1 134k	1 054k	960k	854k	1 150k
2. Latvian SSR (1940 Occup., Shoah, Courland & 1949 Priboi)	1 860k	1 900k	1 930k	1 995k	1 910k	1 740k	1 580k	2 010k
3. Lithuanian SSR (1939 Vilnius, Shoah, LLKS & 1948-51 Exiles)	2 645k	2 740k	2 820k	2 980k	3 030k	2 680k	2 460k	2 620k
4. Moldavian SSR (MASSR + 1940 Bessarabia, 1947 Famine & Op. Yug)	2 040k	2 140k	2 190k	2 410k	2 470k	2 120k	2 080k	2 520k
5. Kaliningrad Oblast (1945 Potsdam, German Expulsion & Settlers)	1 120k	1 140k	1 160k	1 210k	1 220k	1 150k	180k	540k
6. Western Belarus (1939 Annex.: Brest, Grodno, Baranavichy)	2 340k	2 490k	2 590k	2 820k	2 950k	2 280k	2 120k	2 310k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
7. Eastern Byelorussian SSR (Minsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev, Gomel)	4 840k	5 160k	5 110k	5 580k	5 850k	4 220k	4 180k	4 890k
8. Western Ukraine: Galicia & Volhynia (1939 Annex., Shoah & UPA)	6 590k	6 880k	7 080k	7 550k	7 740k	5 950k	5 180k	5 660k
9. N. Bukovina & Budjak (1940) + Transcarpathia (1945 Annex.)	2 360k	2 470k	2 520k	2 690k	2 780k	2 250k	1 920k	2 090k
10. Right-Bank UkSSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy Holodomor)	8 220k	8 560k	7 010k	7 590k	7 880k	6 140k	5 950k	6 630k
11. Left-Bank UkSSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv Holodomor)	9 600k	9 950k	8 150k	8 750k	8 950k	6 850k	6 750k	7 450k
12. Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kryvyi Rih)	3 650k	3 950k	3 550k	4 450k	4 680k	3 450k	3 550k	4 380k
13. Donbas Coal-Steel Basin (Stalino/Donetsk & Voroshilovgrad/ Luhansk)	2 980k	3 650k	3 850k	4 980k	5 320k	3 450k	3 850k	5 420k
14. Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson)	2 650k	2 790k	2 440k	2 890k	3 030k	2 360k	2 350k	2 870k
15. Crimean ASSR -> Oblast (May 1944 Deportation of 191k Tatars)	650k	750k	750k	1 120k	1 180k	750k	600k	980k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
16. Karelo-Finnish SSR (1940-56: Vyborg, 422k Evacuees, BBK) & Murmansk	860k	980k	1 120k	1 390k	1 120k	820k	680k	1 120k
17. Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts (1941-44)	4 690k	5 180k	5 520k	6 300k	6 960k	3 030k	4 340k	5 490k
18. Komi ASSR (1936: Vorkutlag, Intalag, Ukhtpechlag) & Nenets Okrug	240k	280k	340k	430k	490k	540k	560k	750k
19. Northern Forestry & Kulak Exile Belt: Arkhangelsk & Vologda	2 280k	2 470k	2 610k	2 820k	2 930k	2 610k	2 490k	2 930k
20. Moscow Metropolis & Moscow Oblast (Metro, Dmitlag Canal & Hub)	4 570k	5 450k	6 350k	8 450k	8 950k	7 450k	8 150k	10 050k
21. Upper Volga & Western Front (Kalinin, Smolensk, Bryansk, Volgolag)	13 160k	13 050k	12 820k	13 050k	13 280k	10 150k	9 850k	10 790k
22. Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov, Tula)	14 050k	14 350k	13 450k	13 650k	13 850k	10 450k	10 350k	11 150k
23. Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian (Temlag) & Udmurt ASSRs + Gorky/Kirov	6 770k	6 980k	6 880k	7 150k	7 280k	6 950k	6 680k	6 950k
24. Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza Middle Volga	5 210k	5 350k	5 150k	5 380k	5 520k	5 250k	5 020k	5 220k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
25. Kuibyshev (1941-43 Wartime Capital) & Chkalov (Orenburg)	3 650k	3 850k	3 650k	3 950k	4 150k	4 450k	4 150k	4 680k
26. Volga German ASSR (Liquidated Aug 1941: 438k Germans Deported)	572k	600k	480k	606k	620k	210k	250k	340k
27. Saratov, Stalingrad (1942-43 Battle Ruin) & Astrakhan Lower Volga	4 238k	4 400k	3 840k	4 094k	4 250k	3 380k	3 430k	4 040k
28. Kalmyk ASSR (Liquidated Dec 1943 Op. Ulusy: 93,1k Deported)	140k	160k	150k	180k	185k	140k	65k	100k
29. Rostov, Krasnodar (1932-33 Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	7 110k	7 420k	6 280k	6 980k	7 240k	5 920k	6 100k	7 120k
30. Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO (Nov 1943 Deport. 69,3k) & Cherkess AO	1 610k	1 700k	1 520k	1 670k	1 740k	1 430k	1 450k	1 700k
31. Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (Mar 1944 Deport. 37,7k) & N. Ossetian ASSR	680k	740k	760k	890k	930k	820k	760k	930k
32. Chechen-Ingush ASSR -> Grozny Oblast (Feb 1944 Op. Chechevitsa: 493,3k)	590k	640k	650k	760k	790k	710k	340k	490k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
33. Dagestan ASSR (1944 Aukhovsky Chechen Deport. & Mountain Transfers)	710k	740k	740k	830k	860k	720k	680k	760k
34. Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Sverdlovsk, Tankograd, Magnitogorsk)	9 100k	9 950k	10 250k	11 350k	11 900k	13 500k	12 750k	14 390k
35. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Tyumen, Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk)	3 880k	4 220k	4 340k	4 820k	5 080k	5 880k	5 550k	6 340k
36. Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/Nazino, Yugra & Yamal)	360k	480k	620k	680k	720k	790k	750k	820k
37. Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo 1943: Stalinsk)	750k	1 050k	1 320k	1 680k	1 820k	2 150k	2 050k	2 520k
38. Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	2 280k	2 420k	2 380k	2 560k	2 680k	3 050k	2 860k	3 240k
39. Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO, Minusinsk & Tuva AO (1944 Annex.)	490k	560k	620k	740k	780k	820k	810k	960k
40. East Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	1 920k	2 180k	2 380k	2 880k	3 120k	3 410k	3 320k	3 950k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
41. Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka, Taymyr & Evenkia	110k	150k	190k	260k	310k	370k	390k	500k
42. Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/ Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	1 050k	1 180k	1 310k	1 640k	1 740k	1 720k	1 680k	1 970k
43. Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta Exiles)	285k	315k	345k	415k	425k	400k	400k	470k
44. Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan (Sevvostlag) & Chukotka	35k	45k	75k	205k	255k	320k	320k	420k
45. S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937 Koreans) & S. Sakhalin	1 020k	1 270k	1 520k	2 240k	2 560k	2 690k	2 790k	3 640k
Baltic SSRs Total: Estonia, Latvia & Lithuania (Regions 1-3)	5 620k	5 758k	5 874k	6 109k	5 994k	5 380k	4 894k	5 780k
Moldavian SSR Total: Bessarabia & MASSR (Region 4)	2 040k	2 140k	2 190k	2 410k	2 470k	2 120k	2 080k	2 520k
Byelorussian SSR Total (Regions 6-7)	7 180k	7 650k	7 700k	8 400k	8 800k	6 500k	6 300k	7 200k
Ukrainian SSR incl. Crimea Total (Regions 8-15)	36 700k	39 000k	35 350k	40 020k	41 560k	31 200k	30 150k	35 480k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
Russian SFSR + Karelo-Finnish SSR + Kaliningrad Total (Reg. 5, 16-45)	93 530k	99 300k	98 820k	109 260k	113 755k	101 280k	99 195k	114 370k
Combined Total (All 45 Regions: EE + LV + LT + MD + BY + UA + RU)	145 070k	153 848k	149 934k	166 199k	172 579k	146 480k	142 619k	165 350k

Table 1. Population trajectories across the forty-five Stalin-era regions at primary census, famine, and wartime benchmarks (1926AD - 1953AD, in thousands).

Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
1. Estonian SSR (1940 Occup., 1941/49 Priboi & Oil-Shale Inflow)	49 227	1 130k	980k	1 097k	+0,5%	-19,0%	+3,1%
2. Latvian SSR (1940 Occup., Shoah, Courland & 1949 Priboi)	64 240	1 965k	1 780k	1 945k	+1,6%	-17,3%	+8,1%
3. Lithuanian SSR (1939 Vilnius, Shoah, LLKS & 1948-51 Exiles)	64 449	2 910k	2 510k	2 570k	+2,9%	-18,8%	-0,9%
4. Moldavian SSR (MASSR + 1940 Bessarabia, 1947 Famine & Op. Yug)	31 041	2 310k	1 940k	2 290k	+2,3%	-15,8%	+23,5%
5. Kaliningrad Oblast (1945 Potsdam, German Expulsion & Settlers)	16 065	1 190k	340k	475k	+1,8%	-85,2%	-51,8%
6. Western Belarus (1939 Annex.: Brest, Grodno, Baranavichy)	79 213	2 720k	2 160k	2 240k	+4,0%	-28,1%	-1,3%
7. Eastern Byelorussian SSR (Minsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev, Gomel)	122 740	5 280k	4 340k	4 660k	-1,0%	-28,5%	+1,0%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
8. Western Ukraine: Galicia & Volhynia (1939 Annex., Shoah & UPA)	89 118	7 360k	5 300k	5 500k	+2,9%	-33,1%	-14,1%
9. N. Bukovina & Budjak (1940) + Transcarpathia (1945 Annex.)	41 714	2 620k	1 950k	2 020k	+2,0%	-30,9%	-11,4%
10. Right-Bank UkSSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy Holodomor)	133 097	7 200k	5 980k	6 340k	-18,1%	-24,5%	-19,3%
11. Left-Bank UkSSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv Holodomor)	111 513	8 350k	6 720k	7 120k	-18,1%	-24,6%	-22,4%
12. Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kryvyi Rih)	83 237	4 050k	3 620k	4 020k	-10,1%	-24,1%	+20,0%
13. Donbas Coal-Steel Basin (Stalino/Donetsk & Voroshilovgrad/ Luhansk)	52 520	4 550k	4 150k	4 850k	+5,5%	-27,6%	+81,9%
14. Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson)	71 944	2 650k	2 350k	2 630k	-12,5%	-22,4%	+8,3%
15. Crimean ASSR -> Oblast (May 1944 Deportation of 191k Tatars)	32 366	920k	680k	820k	+0,0%	-49,2%	+50,8%
16. Karelo-Finnish SSR (1940-56: Vyborg, 422k Evacuees, BBK) & Murmansk	337 469	1 280k	790k	960k	+14,3%	-39,3%	+30,2%
17. Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts (1941-44)	187 833	5 930k	4 570k	5 065k	+6,6%	-37,6%	+17,1%
18. Komi ASSR (1936: Vorkutlag, Intalag, Ukhtpechlag) & Nenets Okrug	591 270	380k	610k	680k	+21,4%	+14,3%	+212,5%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
19. Northern Forestry & Kulak Exile Belt: Arkhangelsk & Vologda	571 371	2 670k	2 540k	2 740k	+5,7%	-15,0%	+28,5%
20. Moscow Metropolis & Moscow Oblast (Metro, Dmitlag Canal & Hub)	42 148	7 650k	8 550k	9 350k	+16,5%	-8,9%	+119,9%
21. Upper Volga & Western Front (Kalinin, Smolensk, Bryansk, Volgolag)	354 594	12 750k	10 050k	10 480k	-1,8%	-25,8%	-18,0%
22. Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov, Tula)	262 239	13 250k	10 250k	10 750k	-6,3%	-25,3%	-20,6%
23. Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian (Temlag) & Udmurt ASSRs + Gorky/Kirov	299 637	6 950k	6 750k	6 850k	-1,4%	-8,2%	+2,7%
24. Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza Middle Volga	149 881	5 200k	5 080k	5 150k	-3,7%	-9,1%	+0,2%
25. Kuibyshev (1941-43 Wartime Capital) & Chkalov (Orenburg)	182 041	3 750k	4 220k	4 450k	-5,2%	+0,0%	+28,2%
26. Volga German ASSR (Liquidated Aug 1941: 438k Germans Deported)	42 455	520k	275k	310k	-20,0%	-59,7%	-40,6%
27. Saratov, Stalingrad (1942-43 Battle Ruin) & Astrakhan Lower Volga	220 894	3 890k	3 500k	3 780k	-12,7%	-19,3%	-4,7%
28. Kalmyk ASSR (Liquidated Dec 1943 Op. Ulusy: 93,1k Deported)	72 664	160k	75k	90k	-6,2%	-64,9%	-28,6%
29. Rostov, Krasnodar (1932-33 Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	195 023	6 520k	6 260k	6 720k	-15,4%	-15,7%	+0,1%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
30. Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO (Nov 1943 Deport. 69,3k) & Cherkess AO	88 478	1 560k	1 490k	1 600k	-10,6%	-16,7%	+5,6%
31. Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (Mar 1944 Deport. 37,7k) & N. Ossetian ASSR	19 484	830k	790k	860k	+2,7%	-18,3%	+36,8%
32. Chechen-Ingush ASSR -> Grozny Oblast (Feb 1944 Op. Chechevitsa: 493,3k)	15 675	710k	370k	430k	+1,6%	-57,0%	-16,9%
33. Dagestan ASSR (1944 Aukhovsky Chechen Deport. & Mountain Transfers)	56 471	780k	690k	730k	+0,0%	-20,9%	+7,0%
34. Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Sverdlovsk, Tankograd, Magnitogorsk)	592 553	10 800k	12 980k	13 750k	+3,0%	+7,1%	+58,1%
35. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Tyumen, Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk)	515 633	4 550k	5 680k	6 020k	+2,8%	+9,3%	+63,4%
36. Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/ Nazino, Yugra & Yamal)	1 576 022	640k	760k	790k	+29,2%	+4,2%	+127,8%
37. Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo 1943: Stalinsk)	92 689	1 550k	2 120k	2 320k	+25,7%	+12,6%	+236,0%
38. Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	174 518	2 440k	2 930k	3 090k	-1,7%	+6,7%	+42,1%
39. Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO, Minusinsk & Tuva AO (1944 Annex.)	418 838	680k	840k	900k	+10,7%	+3,8%	+95,9%

(Continued from previous page)

Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
40. East Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	867 475	2 620k	3 420k	3 680k	+9,2%	+6,4%	+105,7%
41. Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka, Taymyr & Evenkia	2 108 950	220k	420k	460k	+26,7%	+25,8%	+354,5%
42. Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	840 030	1 480k	1 720k	1 840k	+11,0%	-3,4%	+87,6%
43. Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta Exiles)	3 077 152	385k	415k	445k	+9,5%	-5,9%	+64,9%
44. Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan (Sevvostlag) & Chukotka	2 117 525	135k	335k	375k	+66,7%	+25,5%	+1100,0%
45. S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937 Koreans) & S. Sakhalin	1 064 421	1 830k	2 960k	3 290k	+19,7%	+9,0%	+256,9%
Baltic SSRs Total (Regions 1-3)	177 916	6 005k	5 270k	5 612k	+2,0%	-18,4%	+2,8%
Moldavian SSR Total (Region 4)	31 041	2 310k	1 940k	2 290k	+2,3%	-15,8%	+23,5%
Byelorussian SSR Total (Regions 6-7)	201 953	8 000k	6 500k	6 900k	+0,7%	-28,4%	+0,3%
Ukrainian SSR incl. Crimea Total (Regions 8-15)	615 509	37 700k	30 750k	33 300k	-9,4%	-27,5%	-3,3%
Russian SFSR + Karelo-Finnish SSR + Kaliningrad Total (Reg. 5, 16-45)	17 151 498	103 300k	101 780k	108 430k	-0,5%	-12,8%	+22,3%
Combined Total (All 45 Regions)	18 177 917	157 315k	146 240k	156 532k	-2,5%	-17,4%	+14,0%

Table 2. Regional areas, intermediate demographic benchmarks (1937AD, 1947AD, 1950AD), and net percentage shifts across the forty-five Stalin-era regions.

Collectivisation, Dekulakisation (1930-1933AD), and the 1932-1933AD Famines (Holodomor, Kuban, and Volga)

Origin-to-Destination Accounting of Kulak Special Settlers (Spetspereselentsy) and the May 1933AD Nazino Tragedy

The demographic rupture of the 1930s commenced in November 1929AD with comprehensive forced collectivisation (sploshnaya kollektivizatsiya) and the Politburo resolution of 30 January 1930AD ("On Measures for the Elimination of Kulak Households in Districts of Comprehensive Collectivisation") [3][6]. Peasant households were divided into three categories: first-category "counter-revolutionaries" (~63k household heads arrested by the OGPU in 1930AD, many executed or sent to concentration camps), second-category households slated for freight-train deportation to remote northern, Ural, and Siberian special settlements (spetsposelki), and third-category households dispossessed and resettled on marginal plots within their home districts (archived PDF; archived PDF) [5][38][39].

Declassified OGPU-NKVD ledgers compiled by Viktor Zemskov (1990, 2003) establish that during the two main waves of 1930-1931AD, 381 026 peasant families comprising 1 803 392 persons were exiled into "kulak special settlements" (kulatskaya ssylka); including 1932-1933AD supplemental deportations (such as blacklisted Kuban Cossack stanitsas and Western Siberian/Ukrainian arrears sweeps), total dekulakised exiles reached ~2,1M [4][5][6]. By region of origin, the 1 803 392 spetspereselentsy of 1930-1931AD were uprooted primarily from the Ukrainian SSR (Regions 10-14, 63 720 families, ~301 500 persons), the North Caucasus and Kuban-Don (Regions 29-32, 38 404 families, ~191 900 persons), the Lower and Middle Volga (Regions 24-27, 47 264 families, ~230 500 persons, including ~26k Volga Germans from Region 26), the Central Black-Earth Belt (Region 22, 26 006 families, ~130 000 persons), the Urals and Bashkiria (Region 34, 35 450 families, ~172 000 persons), Western and Eastern Siberia (Regions 35-40, 68 500 families, ~335 000 persons), and Eastern Belarus (Region 7, 15 724 families, ~76 800 persons) [6][38].

Across our 45-region partition, these exiles were consigned to seven primary reception zones (Table 3). Region 34 (Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR): Received the largest single contingent (117 195 families, 561 429 persons in 1930-1931AD), deployed to timber camps (lespromkhozy), bauxite and potash mines (Nadezhdinsk/Serov, Solikamsk, Berezniki, Kizel), and the blast-furnace foundations of Magnitogorsk (40k+ special settlers) and Nizhny Tagil [39][40].

Region 19 (Northern Forestry Belt: Arkhangelsk & Vologda) and Region 18 (Komi ASSR: Ukhtpechlag): Received 57 716 families (290 025 persons) in 1930-1931AD, distributed across logging clearings along the Northern Dvina, Vychegda, and Pechora rivers (Kotlas, Pinega, Syktyvkar, Ust-Kulom, and Ukhta), where winter exposure and scurvy killed over 45k deportees in 1930-1932AD [6].

Region 36 (Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga & Tundra: Narym Okrug, Ostyak-Vogul/Yugra & Yamal-Nenets Okrugs): Received ~265 000 kulak exiles and "declassed elements" shipped by barge down the Ob, Irtysh, Tom, Vasyugan, and Parabel rivers into the swamps of Narym Okrug (~196 000 settlers across Parabel, Kargasok, Kolpashevo, and Vasyugan) and the newly created (December 1930AD) Ostyak-Vogul (Khanty-Mansi) and Yamal-Nenets National Okrugs (Samarovo/Khanty-Mansiysk, Surgut, Berezovo, Salekhard) [6][7]. This forced influx drove Region 36 up by +33,3% from 360k in 1926AD to 480k in 1930AD and +29,2% to 620k in 1933AD (Figure 3). In May 1933AD, the Nazino Island Tragedy unfolded at the confluence of the Ob and Nazina rivers in Alexandrovsky Raion (Region 36): some 6 700 "socially harmful elements" and famine refugees rounded up in Moscow and Leningrad under passport-cleansing quotas were marooned without food, tools, or shelter on swampy Nazino Island; within thirteen weeks, more than 4 000 perished from starvation, exposure, typhus, and cannibalism [7].

Region 37 (Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag) and Region 39 (Khakass AO & Minusinsk): Received ~145

000 special settlers assigned to coal mines at Prokopyevsk, Anzhero-Sudzhensk, Leninsk-Kuznetsky, and Kemerovo, the Kuznetsk Metallurgical Combine at Stalinsk, and gold/coal mines in Khakassia (Chernogorsk, Balyksinsk, Sarala) [6].

Regions 40, 41, 43, and 45 (East Siberia, Yenisei-Taymyr Igarka, Aldan Gold & Far East): Received ~185 000 special settlers, notably at the Arctic timber-export port of Igarka (Region 41, where >20k kulak exiles built sawmills on permafrost at 67,5°N), the Aldan goldfields (Region 43), and Far Eastern mining and timber districts (Region 45). Between 1930AD and 1934AD, recorded deaths in the kulak special settlements exceeded 500 000 (151 601 deaths, or 13,7% of the entire contingent, in the famine year 1933AD alone) [6].

Special-Settlement Reception Region (45-Region Partition)	1930-31 Families	1930-33 Deportees	Primary Origins & Demographic / Settlement Impact
Reg. 34: Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Magnitogorsk, Serov, Solikamsk, Tagil)	117 195	561 429	From Ukraine, Kuban, Volga & Black-Earth; built Magnitogorsk (40k exiles), Kizel coal & Ural timber
Reg. 19 & Reg. 18: Northern Krai (Arkhangelsk, Kotlas) & Komi ASSR (Syktyvkar, Ukhta)	57 716	290 025	From Ukraine, Belarus & Central Russia; cleared Dvina/Pechora timber; Reg. 18 grew +41,7% (1926-33)
Reg. 36: Ob-Irtysh Taiga: Narym Okrug (Vasyugan, Nazino) & Ostyak-Vogul / Yamal	52 400	265 000	From Ukraine, Volga & W. Siberia; Narym swamps & May 1933 Nazino Island tragedy (>4 000 of 6 700 died)
Reg. 37 & Reg. 39: Kuzbass Coal-Steel (Stalinsk, Prokopyevsk) & Khakassia Mines	31 200	145 000	From Volga, Black-Earth & Siberia; staffed Kuzbass coal shafts, Siblag & Khakass gold/coal mines
Reg. 35 & Reg. 38: Southern West Siberia (Omsk, Novosibirsk) & Altai Krai	22 100	105 000	Internal West Siberian & Ukrainian kulaks settled in Baraba steppe and northern Altai timber tracts
Reg. 40 & Reg. 41: Krasnoyarsk Krai, Irkutsk & Igarka Arctic Timber Port	26 800	130 000	Built Igarka permafrost port (Reg. 41: +72,7% in 1926-33) & Yenisei/ Angara logging settlements
Reg. 42, 43 & 45: Transbaikalia, Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold) & Southern Far East	21 400	102 000	Staffed Aldan goldfields (Reg. 43), Transbaikal mines & Far Eastern timber/coal camps (Reg. 45)
Kazakhstan, Central Asia, North Caucasus Steppe & Internal Regional Exile	52 215	501 546	Included Karaganda coal basin (Kazakhstan) & internal third-category resettlement zones
All-Union Kulak Special-Settlement Total (1930-1933AD OGPU-NKVD Accounting)	381 026	2 100 000	1 803 392 deported in 1930-31 (+300k in 1932-33); >500k died in exile (151 601 deaths in 1933AD)

Table 3. Origin-to-destination accounting of dekulakised peasant special settlers across the forty-five Stalin-era regions from 1930AD to 1933AD.

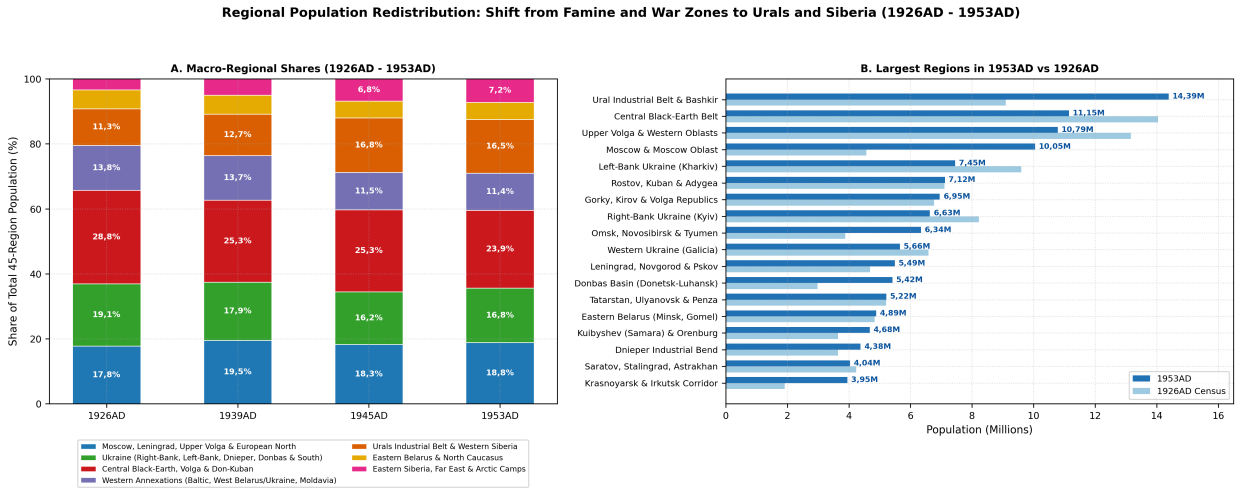


Figure 3. Regional percentage population shifts during the 1930AD - 1933AD collectivisation famines and the 1941AD - 1953AD wartime and post-war era.

The 1932-1933AD Famines across Ukrainian Regions 10-14, MASSR, and Russian Regions 22, 24-30

In the Ukrainian SSR, the combination of collectivisation livestock losses, extortionate 1932AD state grain-procurement quotas (khlebozagotovki), “natural meat and potato fines” (naturalnye shtrafy), the “blackboard” blockade regime (chernye doski), and Stalin and Molotov’s secret directive of 22 January 1933AD forbidding peasant exit from Ukraine and the Kuban produced the Holodomor [8][9][41]. Reconstructions by the Ptoukha Institute and the Harvard Ukrainian Research Institute (HURI) MAPA project establish 3,94M direct excess deaths across the interwar Ukrainian SSR (including the Moldavian ASSR) during 1932-1934AD (3,53M in 1933AD alone) plus 0,59M lost births (4,53M total demographic loss) [8][9].

Our 45-region partition cleanly separates the interwar Polish, Romanian, Baltic, and Czechoslovak borderlands (Regions 1-3, the Bessarabian majority of Region 4, and Regions 6, 8, and 9, which were outside Soviet borders in 1932-1933AD) from the five Soviet Ukrainian regions (Regions 10 through 14) and the Russian famine regions (Regions 22, 24-30) (Figure 3, and Table 4). Region 10 (Right-Bank Ukrainian SSR: Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy): Refined by assigning the Moldavian SSR to dedicated Region 4, Right-Bank Ukraine suffered rural excess mortality rates of 165 to 250+ per 1 000 in Tetiev, Bila Tserkva, Uman, and Vinnytsia raions, plunging by -18,1% from 8 560k (1930AD) to 7 010k (1933AD, -1 550k net loss; ~1 650k direct famine deaths) [9]. Meanwhile, in the left-bank Moldavian ASSR (Balta and Tiraspol districts, split in 1940AD between Region 4 and Region 14), ~50k to 67k inhabitants died during the 1932-1933AD famine (archived PDF) [20][42].

Region 11 (Left-Bank Ukrainian SSR: Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv): Subjected to sweeping household food confiscations and chernye doski blockades (such as Liutenka and Kamiani Potoky), plunging by -18,1% from 9 950k (1930AD) to 8 150k (1933AD, -1 800k net loss; ~1 295k direct famine deaths) [8].

Region 14 (Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe: Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson, including Balta) and Region 12 (Dnieper Industrial Bend): Region 14 fell by -12,5% (2 790k to 2 440k; ~395k direct deaths including northern MASSR raions retained in Odesa Oblast), and Region 12 fell by -10,1% (3 950k to 3 550k; ~370k rural famine deaths partially offset by industrial construction at Zaporizhzhia’s DniproHES and Kryvyi

Rih), whereas Region 13 (Donbas) rose by +5,5% (3 650k to 3 850k) as priority coal/steel rations drew starving peasants into Stalino and Voroshilovgrad mines despite ~230k rural Donetsk famine deaths.

Region 26 (Volga German ASSR) and Region 27 (Saratov, Stalingrad & Astrakhan Lower Volga): Isolated as its own republic in our 45-region partition, the Volga German ASSR (Region 26) suffered the steepest percentage drop of any Russian unit in 1930-1933AD, plunging by -20,0% from 600k (1930AD) to 480k (1933AD) as relentless grain requisitions across Marxstadt, Balzer, Seelmann, and Frank cantons killed ~65k to 80k Volga Germans and triggered flight across the Volga [10][43]. Adjacent Region 27 (Saratov & Stalingrad) fell by -12,7% (4 400k to 3 840k; ~405k direct famine deaths).

Region 29 (Rostov, Krasnodar/Kuban & Adygei AO) and Region 30 (Stavropol & Karachay-Cherkess): Directed by Lazar Kaganovich's November 1932AD North Caucasus commission, the OGPU placed fifteen major Kuban Cossack stanitsas on "blackboards" (chernye doski), cordoned them off from trade and food, and deported the entire surviving population of Ukrainian-speaking Poltavskaya (~27k residents, renamed Krasnoarmeyskaya), Medvedovskaya, and Urupskaya to the northern Gulag while resettling demobilised Red Army soldiers into their homes (archived PDF) [10][11]. Region 29 plunged by -15,4% from 7 420k (1930AD) to 6 280k (1933AD), while Region 30 (Stavropol) fell by -10,6% (1 700k to 1 520k; ~620k combined North Caucasus famine deaths).

Region 22 (Central Black-Earth Belt), Region 24 (Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza), and Region 25 (Kuibyshev & Chkalov): Region 22 dropped by -6,3% (14 350k to 13 450k; ~520k direct famine deaths in Voronezh, Kursk, Belgorod, and Tambov), Region 25 fell by -5,2% (3 850k to 3 650k), and Region 24 fell by -3,7% (5 350k to 5 150k) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [44][45][46].

Stalin-Era Famine Region (45-Region Partition)	1930AD	1933AD	1930-33 Shift	Direct Deaths	Raion Mortality & Repression Mechanisms
Reg. 10: Right-Bank Ukrainian SSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy)	8 560k	7 010k	-18,1%	1 650k	165-250+ per 1k (Tetiev, Uman, Bila Tserkva); natural meat/potato fines & border cordons
Reg. 11: Left-Bank Ukrainian SSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv)	9 950k	8 150k	-18,1%	1 295k	155-210 per 1k; chernye doski (blackboards), OGPU rail blocks & June 1933 mortality peak
Reg. 12: Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kirovohrad)	3 950k	3 550k	-10,1%	370k	138 per 1k; rural famine sweeps partially offset in aggregate by DniproHES/ Kryvyi Rih boom
Reg. 13: Donbas Basin (Stalino/Donetsk & Voroshilovgrad/Luhansk)	3 650k	3 850k	+5,5%	230k	68 per 1k; rural Donetsk starvation offset by priority coal/steel rations & in-migration
Reg. 14: Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson, Balta)	2 790k	2 440k	-12,5%	397k	152 per 1k; steppe & Balta/ MASSR requisitions (+50k deaths in Tiraspol/ left-bank MASSR)
Ukrainian SSR Famine Zone Total (Regions 10-14, excl. W. Ukraine Reg. 8-9)	28 900k	25 000k	-13,5%	3 942k	133 per 1k; 3,94M direct deaths + 0,59M lost births (4,53M total Holodomor deficit)

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Stalin-Era Famine Region (45-Region Partition)	1930AD	1933AD	1930-33 Shift	Direct Deaths	Raion Mortality & Repression Mechanisms
Reg. 26: Volga German ASSR (Engels, Marxstadt, Balzer, Seelmann Cantons)	600k	480k	-20,0%	75k	135 per 1k; extreme requisitions across Volga German cantons; -20,0% net population drop
Reg. 27: Lower Volga (Saratov, Stalingrad & Astrakhan)	4 400k	3 840k	-12,7%	405k	108 per 1k; total seed/grain sweeps across Saratov & Stalingrad rural khutors
Reg. 29: Rostov, Krasnodar (Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	7 420k	6 280k	-15,4%	480k	132 per 1k; Kaganovich commission, 15 Cossack stanitsas blacklisted (Poltavskaya exiled)
Reg. 30: Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO & Cherkess AO	1 700k	1 520k	-10,6%	140k	105 per 1k; grain confiscations & kulak deportations across Stavropol & Terek steppe
Reg. 22: Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov)	14 350k	13 450k	-6,3%	520k	64 per 1k; spring-summer 1933 famine across Voronezh, Kursk, Belgorod & Tambov
Reg. 24 & Reg. 25: Middle Volga (Tatar ASSR, Penza, Kuibyshev, Chkalov)	9 200k	8 800k	-4,3%	370k	55 per 1k; grain requisitions across Samara, Orenburg, Penza & Ulyanovsk
Russian SFSR + KFSSR Total (Regions 16-45, 2,63M Direct Famine Deaths)	98 160k	97 660k	-0,5%	2 630k	2,63M direct famine deaths + 0,67M lost births across RSFSR (+640k in Urals/Siberia/Rest)

Table 4. Population shifts, direct famine mortality, and repression mechanisms across Ukrainian and Russian famine regions from 1930AD to 1933AD.

Western Soviet Annexations (Regions 1 - 5): The Baltic SSRs, Moldavian SSR, and Kaliningrad Oblast (1926AD - 1953AD)

The forty-five-region partition incorporates five western borderland territories whose demographic trajectories between 1926AD and 1953AD were transformed by the August 1939AD Molotov-Ribbentrop secret protocols, the 1939-1941AD German *Umsiedlung*, the 1940AD Soviet annexations and June 1941AD NKVD deportations, the 1941-1944AD Nazi and Romanian occupations and the Holocaust, wartime sea flight and post-war population expulsions, prolonged anti-Soviet partisan insurgencies, the catastrophic 1946-1947AD Moldavian famine, and the 1948-1951AD mass collectivisation deportations (Operations *Vesna*, *Priboi*, *Yug* and *Osen*) (Table 5) [4][18][20][28][47].

Region 1: Estonian SSR (1 115k in 1926AD -> 1 134k in 1939AD -> 854k in 1945AD -> 1 150k in 1953AD)

In interwar independent Estonia (49 227 km2), low Western European-style fertility and modest urban growth in Tallinn (127k in 1926AD -> 145k in 1939AD), Tartu (59k -> 60,1k) and Narva carried the population slowly from 1 115k in 1926AD to 1 134k in September 1939AD [48][49]. Between October 1939AD and June 1941AD, Estonia lost ~80k inhabitants (1 134k -> 1 054k): following Hitler's 6 October 1939AD Reichstag call, ~14 000 Baltic Germans departed during the 1939-1940AD *Umsiedlung* (followed by ~7 000 *Nachumsiedler* in early 1941AD); after the June-August 1940AD Soviet occupation and annexation, NKVD troops arrested ~8 000 political and military figures, deported 10 157 men, women and children on 14 June 1941AD to Kirov Oblast and Novosibirsk/Tomsk (Region 35-36), and conscripted ~33 000 Estonian men into Red Army labour battalions in the summer of 1941AD (archived PDF; archived PDF) [17][50][51].

Under Nazi German occupation (July 1941AD - September 1944AD), *Einsatzgruppe A* and Estonian collaborationist units murdered virtually all ~1 000 Estonian Jews remaining in the country (such that Nazi authorities declared Estonia *judenfrei* at the January 1942AD Wannsee Conference) alongside ~7 000 to 8 000 foreign Jews transported to the Vaivara, Klooga and Kalevi-Liiva camps and ~7 800 local civilians and Roma (archived PDF) [17][52]. As the Red Army breached the Narva front (destroying >95% of baroque Narva, whose population fell from 23,8k in 1939AD to 6,6k in 1945AD) and reoccupied Tallinn in autumn 1944AD, 75 000 to 80 000 Estonians (together with ~7 000 Estonian Swedes from Vormsi, Noarootsi and Ruhnu) fled across the Baltic Sea to Sweden and Germany [48][49]. In January 1945AD, Moscow detached eastern Ivangorod and the bulk of Petseri (*Pechory*) County (~2 300 km2, ~55k-65k inhabitants) from the Estonian SSR into Leningrad and Pskov Oblasts (Region 17), depressing Estonia's post-war trough to 854k in late 1945AD (-24,7% below 1939AD).

Post-war Sovietisation provoked armed resistance by ~14 000 to 15 000 Estonian *Metsavennad* (Forest Brothers) across Virumaa, Vorumaa and Parnumaa [17][28]. To crush rural support for the insurgents and force peasant entry into kolkhozes, MGB and MVD troops executed Operation *Priboi* ("Coastal Surf") on 25-28 March 1949AD, deporting 20 702 Estonians (7 552 families, >70% women and children under sixteen) in 19 freight echelons to Novosibirsk, Omsk, Krasnoyarsk and Irkutsk Oblasts (Regions 35 and 40) (archived PDF) [18][50]. Simultaneously, rapid all-Union investment in the northeastern Virumaa oil-shale gas basin (Kohtla-Jarve, founded as a city in 1946AD to supply piped shale gas to Leningrad, growing to 29k by 1953AD), Kreenholm textiles in Narva (21k in 1953AD, after indigenous pre-war residents were barred from returning) and the secret Combine No. 7 uranium-enrichment facility at Sillamae (10k in 1953AD) brought >180 000 Russian, Belarusian and Ingrian industrial migrants into Estonia, lifting Region 1 to 1 150k by 1953AD while reducing the ethnic Estonian share from 88,2% (1934AD) to ~75% (archived PDF) [48][49][53].

Region 2: Latvian SSR (1 860k in 1926AD -> 1 995k in 1939AD -> 1 580k in 1945AD -> 2 010k in 1953AD)

Interwar Latvia (64 240 km2) expanded from 1 860k in 1926AD to 1 995k in 1939AD, anchored by Riga (339k -> 385k), Liepaja (57k), Daugavpils (43k -> 51,7k) and Jelgava (28,3k -> 34,1k) [54][55]. Between October 1939AD and June 1941AD, the *Umsiedlung* removed ~51 000 Baltic Germans (plus ~10 500 in early 1941AD), virtually ending seven centuries of German urban presence in Riga and Courland; following the June-August 1940AD Soviet annexation, the NKVD deported 15 424 Latvian citizens (disproportionately targeting political, military and Jewish business elites) on 14 June 1941AD to Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 40), Tomsk/Novosibirsk (Region 35-36) and the Vyatlag/Usollag camps (Regions 23 and 34), where ~34% perished (archived PDF) [56][57].

During the 1941-1945AD Nazi occupation (*Reichskommissariat Ostland*), the Latvian Holocaust annihilated

~70 000 Latvian Jews (~90% of the pre-war Jewish community not evacuated to the Soviet interior) alongside ~20 000 Reich Jews deported from Germany, Austria and Czechoslovakia and ~2 000 Latvian Roma [23][56]. On 30 November and 8 December 1941AD, SS Gen. Friedrich Jeckeln's forces and the Arajs Kommando shot 25 000 Jews from the Riga Ghetto in the Rumbula forest, alongside mass shootings in Bikernieki forest (~35k-46k total victims), the Skede dunes outside Liepaja, Daugavpils Citadel and Rezekne [23]. Heavy conscription into the Latvian Waffen-SS Legion (~110k-115k) and the Red Army, fierce 1944-1945AD fighting around Jelgava and the Courland Pocket (*Kurzemes cietoksnis*, which held out until 8 May 1945AD), the flight of 120 000 to 150 000 Latvian refugees by sea to Germany and Sweden, and the August 1944AD transfer of eastern Abrene (*Pytalovo*) district (1 293 km2, ~45k inhabitants) to RSFSR Pskov Oblast (Region 17) reduced Latvia's population by -20,8% from 1 995k (1939AD) to 1 580k in 1945AD [55][56].

Between 1944AD and 1953AD, ~20 000 Latvian national partisans (*Nacionalie partizani*) waged guerrilla warfare in the forests of Kurzeme, Vidzeme and Latgale [28]. During Operation *Priboi* (25-29 March 1949AD), 33 echelons deported 42 149 Latvians (13 624 families - 2,3% of Latvia's population in four days) to Amur Oblast (Region 45), Omsk and Tomsk Oblasts (Region 35-36), triggering instant mass collectivisation (11% to >90% of farms by late 1949AD) [18][57]. Simultaneously, heavy union-ministry industrialisation in Riga (*VEF* electronics, *RVR* railcars, shipbuilding; growing from 228k in late 1944/1945AD to 530k in 1953AD), Daugavpils (56k) and Liepaja (64k) drew >350 000 Russian, Belarusian and Ukrainian workers and military personnel, carrying Region 2 to 2 010k by 1953AD while lowering the ethnic Latvian share from 77% (1935AD) to ~62% [54][56].

Region 3: Lithuanian SSR (2 645k in 1926AD -> 3 030k in 1941AD -> 2 460k in 1945AD -> 2 620k in 1953AD)

Lithuania (64 449 km2, evaluated across its post-1945AD borders including both the Vilnius region and Klaipeda/Memel) grew from 2 645k in 1926AD to 2 980k in 1939AD and 3 030k in early 1941AD [58][59]. Its borders shifted twice before Barbarossa: in March 1939AD Nazi Germany annexed the Klaipeda (*Memel*) Territory (~154k inhabitants), whereas in October 1939AD - after invading eastern Poland - the USSR transferred the city of Vilnius (*Wilno*, 209k in 1939AD) and its immediate hinterland (~549k inhabitants) to Lithuania, followed by full Soviet occupation in June 1940AD (adding Swieciany/Svencionys and Druskininkai from Belarus), the early-1941AD *Umsiedlung* of ~50 000 ethnic Germans and German-registered Lutherans, and the 14-18 June 1941AD NKVD deportation of 17 485 people to Altai Krai (Region 38), Novosibirsk (Region 35) and the Komi ASSR (Region 18, *Sevzheldorlag* and *Vorkutlag*) [19][58][60].

Between June and December 1941AD, Lithuania suffered one of the most total and rapid genocides in Europe: *Einsatzkommando 3* (Karl Jager) and Lithuanian collaborationist auxiliaries (*Ypatingasis burys* and TDA battalions) murdered 190 000 to 195 000 Lithuanian and Vilnius Jews - over 91-95% of Lithuania's pre-war Jewish population - at Ponary (*Paneriai*) outside Vilnius (~70 000 Jews shot alongside ~20 000 Polish intelligentsia and Soviet POWs), the Ninth Fort at Kaunas (>30 000 victims) and over two hundred provincial *shtetl* murder pits across Siauliai, Panevezys, Ukmerge and Alytus [23][58]. In late 1944AD and January 1945AD, ~60 000 Lithuanians fled west, while retreating Wehrmacht authorities evacuated virtually the entire civilian population of Klaipeda (reducing the port from 48,5k in 1939AD to fewer than 4k-6k civilians at liberation in January 1945AD). Between 1945AD and 1946AD, under the Polish-Lithuanian evacuation agreements, 170 000 to 197 156 ethnic Poles were repatriated from Vilnius (110k in 1945AD) and eastern Lithuania to Poland, radically transforming Vilnius from a Polish-Jewish city into a Soviet Lithuanian-Russian administrative capital [58].

Unlike Estonia and Latvia, post-war Lithuania experienced minimal all-Union Slavic industrial

immigration before 1953AD because the countryside was engulfed in the fiercest anti-Soviet guerrilla war in the USSR (1944-1953AD): the Lithuanian Forest Brothers (*Misko broliai*, united in 1949AD as the Movement of the Struggle for Freedom of Lithuania, *LLKS*, under Jonas Zemaitis and Adolfas Ramanauskas) mobilised ~30 000 to 50 000 active fighters over the conflict, losing 20 101 partisans killed in combat while killing ~13 000 MGB/MVD personnel, *istrebiteli* militia and Soviet activists (archived PDF) [19][28][61]. In retaliation, Moscow subjected Lithuania to four massive serial deportations totalling 131 600 to 132 000 post-war deportees (1945-1953AD, plus ~142 000 Gulag political prisoners). Early post-war sweeps (1945-1947AD): ~12 000 partisans' relatives and Lithuanian Germans deported to Tajikistan, Komi (Region 18) and Sverdlovsk (Region 34).

Operation *Vesna* ("Spring", 22-23 May 1948AD): The largest single deportation in Lithuanian history, in which 30 000 MGB/MVD troops deported 40 002 to 48 000 Lithuanians (11 345+ families) to timber camps in Irkutsk Oblast (Region 40: Igirma, Bodaibo, Tayshet, Tulun), Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 40-41: Igarka, Yeniseysk) and the Buryat-Mongol ASSR (Region 42) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [60][62][63].

Operation *Priboi* (25-28 March 1949AD): Deported 29 180 to 32 000 Lithuanians (8 765 families) to Irkutsk and Krasnoyarsk [18][60].

Operation *Osen* ("Autumn", 2-3 October 1951AD): Deported 16 150 to 20 357 remaining *kulak* family members to Krasnoyarsk and Tomsk Oblasts, alongside smaller sweeps into the Kazakh SSR (archived PDF) [60][64].

Consequently, Lithuania (Region 3) fell from 3 030k in 1941AD to 2 460k in 1945AD (-18,8%) and crept back to only 2 620k by 1953AD (-13,5% below 1941AD and even -0,9% below its 1926AD baseline!).

Region 4: Moldavian SSR (2 040k in 1926AD -> 2 470k in 1941AD -> 1 940k in 1947AD Famine Trough -> 2 520k in 1953AD)

Dedicated Region 4 (31 041 km2) unites central and northern Bessarabia (Chisinau, Balti, Bender, Orhei, Soroca, Cahul - held by Greater Romania from 1918AD to June 1940AD) with the western Transnistrian bank of the Moldavian ASSR (MASSR, 1924-1940AD) (Tiraspol, Ribnita, Dubasari, Slobozia), while assigning northern/eastern MASSR raions (Balta, Birzula/Kotovsk, Ananiv) to Ukrainian Region 14 and southern Budjak (Izmail, Cetatea Alba/Bilhorod-Dnistrovskyi) to Ukrainian Region 9 (archived PDF) [20][42]. During the interwar period, left-bank MASSR (572,3k in 1926AD across all 11 original raions) endured dekulakisation, the 1932-1933AD famine (~50k-67k excess deaths, prompting desperate peasant attempts to swim the Dniester into Romania under OGPU border-guard fire, such as the February 1932AD Olaneasca/Oloneshty crossing) and the 1937-1938AD NKVD "Romanian Operation" (~5 500+ executions in Tiraspol), whereas Romanian-ruled Bessarabia experienced high rural natural increase, lifting Region 4 overall from 2 040k (1926AD) to 2 410k (1939AD) [20][42].

On 28 June 1940AD, following the Soviet ultimatum to Romania, the Red Army occupied Bessarabia and on 2 August 1940AD proclaimed the Moldavian SSR (Chisinau capital) [20]. In autumn 1940AD, 93 468 Bessarabian Germans evacuated from southern/central German colonies under the Nazi-Soviet *Umsiedlung* (Heim ins Reich), tens of thousands of Romanian officials fled across the Prut, and on 12-13 June 1941AD the NKVD arrested or deported 22 648 to 29 839 inhabitants from the Moldavian SSR (and ~6k-11k from Chernivtsi/Izmail in Region 9) to Kazakhstan, Omsk, Novosibirsk and Komi [4][20].

During the 1941-1944AD Axis campaign, Ion Antonescu's Romanian regime reoccupied Bessarabia and administered *Transnistria* between the Dniester and Southern Bug (Regions 4, 9, 10 and 14), perpetrating the Bessarabian and Transnistrian Holocaust (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF) [23][24][65][66]: Romanian gendarmes, army units and German *Einsatzgruppe D* murdered ~45k-60k Jews directly in Bessarabian ghettos and transit camps (Chisinau Ghetto, Marculesti, Vertujeni, Edinet) and

force-marched the survivors alongside Bukovinian Jews and 25 000 Romanian Roma into lethal starvation and typhus camps across Transnistria (Bogdanovka, Domanevka, Akhmetchetka, Vapniarka, Mogilev-Podolsky), where 200 000 to 280 000 local and deported Jews and ~11 000 Roma perished [24][66]. Heavy 1944AD combat (the Jassy-Kishinev Offensive, which left central Chisinau >70% destroyed, dropping from 112k in 1939AD to 65k in 1945AD) reduced Region 4 from 2 470k (1941AD) to 2 080k in 1945AD.

Worse still followed in peace: between autumn 1946AD and summer 1947AD, severe two-year drought across Bessarabia combined with relentless MGB/party grain-procurement sweeps (khlebozagotovki enforced despite near-total crop failure) triggered the 1946-1947AD Moldavian Famine (archived PDF) [20][26][27][67]. Excess deaths in the Moldavian SSR reached 115 000 to 200 000 (5% to 8% of the entire republic's population - the highest per-capita mortality anywhere in the post-war USSR), accompanied by >390 000 cases of alimentary dystrophy and hundreds of documented cases of cannibalism in Cahul, Bender, Orhei and Balti districts, driving Region 4 down further from 2 080k (1945AD) to its 1 940k famine trough in 1947AD [26][27]. Two years later, on 6-7 July 1949AD, MGB forces executed Operation *Yug* ("South"), deporting 35 796 Moldavian peasants (11 293 families labelled *kulaks*, former Romanian landowners or Jehovah's Witnesses - followed by 2 617 Jehovah's Witnesses in April 1951AD Operation *Sever*) in 30 freight echelons to Kurgan and Tyumen Oblasts (Region 35), Altai Krai (Region 38), Irkutsk (Region 40) and the Kazakh SSR, breaking peasant resistance to full collectivisation under First Secretary Nikolay Koval and his 1950-1952AD successor Leonid Brezhnev (archived PDF) [20][68]. High rural post-famine natality and Slavic administrative/industrial in-migration to Chisinau (165k in 1953AD) and Tiraspol (48k) then restored Region 4 to 2 520k by 1953AD.

Region 5: Kaliningrad Oblast (1 120k in 1926AD -> 1 220k in 1941AD -> 180k in 1945AD -> 540k in 1953AD)

Dedicated Region 5 (16 065 km2) isolates Northern East Prussia, awarded to the USSR at the July-August 1945AD Potsdam Conference and incorporated directly into the Russian SFSR on 7 April 1946AD as *Konigsberg Oblast* (renamed Kaliningrad Oblast on 4 July 1946AD) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [25][47][69][70]. Under Weimar and Nazi rule, Northern East Prussia was a densely settled German urban and agrarian province (1 120k in 1926AD -> 1 210k in the May 1939AD Reich census -> 1 220k in 1941AD), led by the provincial capital and Baltic port of Konigsberg (287k in 1926AD -> 372,2k in 1939AD), Tilsit (*Sovetsk*) (50,8k -> 59,1k), Insterburg (*Chernyakhovsk*) (39,3k -> 48,7k), Pillau (*Baltiysk*) (12,4k) and Gumbinnen (*Gusev*) (24,6k).

During the Red Army's East Prussian Offensive (January - April 1945AD), the storming of Konigsberg (6-9 April 1945AD) and the Samland/Pillau battles, ~900 000 to 1 000 000 German civilians fled west across the Frische Haff and by sea from Pillau or perished in combat, leaving an estimated 129 000 to 139 000 surviving German civilians (mostly women, children and the elderly, alongside initial Red Army garrisons and repatriated POWs, yielding 180k total inhabitants in late 1945AD - an -85,2% demographic collapse from 1941AD, the steepest wartime drop of all 45 regions!) (archived PDF) [47][71]. Between 1945AD and 1947AD, severe hunger, typhus, forced labour and lack of rations reduced the surviving German civilian population to ~103 000 (with documented exhaustion mortality and isolated starvation crimes during the 1946-1947AD winter) [47][69]. Under Council of Ministers Resolution No. 3547-1169ss (11 October 1947AD), MVD authorities carried out the compulsory deportation of 102 125 to 102 405 remaining Germans between October 1947AD and November 1948AD (plus final stragglers in 1951AD) in 48 passenger/freight trains to the Soviet Occupation Zone of Germany, effecting a 100% ethnic and toponymic replacement of the province [25][71].

To repopulate the shattered cities and flooded polder farmland, Stalin signed Resolution No. 1298 (21 June

1946AD), launching a massive organised resettlement campaign (*Pereselencheskoe upravlenie*) from thirty war-ravaged oblasts and republics - above all Bryansk, Smolensk, Kalinin, Oryol, Kursk, Voronezh, Tambov and Gorky Oblasts (Regions 21-23), the Mordovian and Chuvash ASSRs (Region 23) and Belarus (Regions 6-7) - alongside demobilised Baltic Fleet sailors at Baltiysk and Kaliningrad (archived PDF) [25][70][72]. Despite high reverse migration (25-35% of early kolkhoz settlers left due to ruined housing and unfamiliar drainage systems), steady state recruitment lifted Region 5 from 180k (1945AD) to 340k (1947AD), 475k (1950AD) and 540k in 1953AD (Kaliningrad city reaching 175k, Sovetsk 28k, Chernyakhovsk 26k), still -55,7% below its 1941AD pre-war level.

Western Soviet Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1941AD	1945AD	1947AD	1953AD	Umsiedlung, Shoah, Flight, Famine & 1948-51 Deportations
Reg. 1: Estonian SSR (Tallinn, Tartu, Kohtla-Jarve, Narva, Sillamae)	1 115k	1 054k	854k	980k	1 150k	21k Germans out; 10,2k exiled (1941); 78k fled sea (1944); Ivangorod/Petseri to RSFSR; 20,7k Priboi (Mar 1949); >180k shale/ uranium workers in
Reg. 2: Latvian SSR (Riga, Liepaja, Daugavpils, Jelgava, Ventspils)	1 860k	1 910k	1 580k	1 780k	2 010k	61k Germans out; 15,4k exiled (1941); 70k Latvian Jews murdered (Rumbula); 135k fled West; Abrene to RSFSR; 42,1k Priboi (1949); >350k Slavic workers in
Reg. 3: Lithuanian SSR (Vilnius, Kaunas, Klaipeda, Siauliai, Panevezys)	2 645k	3 030k	2 460k	2 510k	2 620k	50k Germans out; 17,5k exiled (1941); 195k Jews murdered (>91%, Ponary/ 9th Fort); 185k Poles to Poland; 20k LLKS partisans killed; 132k exiled (Vesna/Priboi/ Osen)
Reg. 4: Moldavian SSR (Chisinau, Tiraspol, Balti, Bender, Orhei)	2 040k	2 470k	2 080k	1 940k	2 520k	57k MASSR famine deaths (1933); 93,5k Germans out (1940); 22,6k-29,8k exiled (1941); 200-280k Shoah deaths; 115-200k died in 1946-47 famine; 35,8k Op. Yug (1949)
Reg. 5: Kaliningrad Oblast / N. East Prussia (Kaliningrad, Sovetsk)	1 120k	1 220k	180k	340k	540k	950k Germans fled/died (1945); 35k died of hunger/typhus (1945-47); 102 405 Germans deported to SBZ (1947-48); >420k Russian/Belarusian settlers & Baltic Fleet in

(Continued from previous page)

Western Soviet Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1941AD	1945AD	1947AD	1953AD	Umsiedlung, Shoah, Flight, Famine & 1948-51 Deportations
Western Annexation Belt Total (Regions 1-5 Combined)	8 780k	9 684k	7 154k	7 550k	8 840k	Combined 1941-45 loss of -2 530k (-26,1%); >250k Baltic/Moldavian peasants deported in 1948-51 (Vesna, Priboi, Yug, Osen) to Siberia & Kazakhstan

Table 5. Demographic trajectories, wartime losses, the 1946AD - 1947AD famine, and post-war deportations across the five western regions (1926AD - 1953AD).

Border Cleansings, the 1937AD Korean Exile, Karelia, and the Volga-Ural ASSRs

Pre-War Border Cleansings (1935-1938AD), the 1937AD Korean Deportation (Region 45), and the Great Terror

Between 1935AD and 1938AD, Soviet demographic policy shifted from class-based dekulakisation to pre-emptive ethnic cleansing of western and eastern border zones [4][12][22]. Western Border-Zone Expulsions of Poles, Germans and Ingrian Finns (1935-1936AD): In February-March 1935AD and January-September 1936AD, the NKVD deported ~42 000 Polish and German families (~195 000 persons, including the liquidation of the Marchlewski Polish National Raion and Pulin German National Raion in Zhytomyr/Volhynia, Region 10, and border raions of Region 7 in Belarus) to northern Kazakhstan and Siberia; simultaneously, in 1935-1936AD, ~27 000 to 45 000 Ingrian Finns (*Inkerilaiset*) were forcibly cleared from the Estonian and Finnish border raions of Leningrad Oblast (Region 17) and Karelia (Region 16) to Vologda, Western Siberia and Tajikistan [4][12].

The September-October 1937AD Total Deportation of 171 781 Soviet Koreans from Primorye (Region 45): Under Sovnarkom and Central Committee Resolution No. 1428-326ss of 21 August 1937AD (signed by Stalin and Molotov), the entire ethnic Korean population (*Koryo-saram*) of the Soviet Far East (Region 45: Posyet, Vladivostok, Spassk, Ussuriysk/Voroshilov and Khabarovsk border districts) was subjected to the first total nationality deportation in Soviet history [4][22]. Within eight weeks (September-October 1937AD), 124 echelons transported 36 442 Korean families (171 781 persons) across 6 000 kilometres to Uzbekistan (76 525) and Kazakhstan (95 256), where ~25k to 40k died of exposure and typhus during 1937-1938AD, while vacated Korean collective farms in Region 45 were repopulated by demobilised Red Army men and Russian/Ukrainian settlers [4].

The 1937-1938AD Great Terror and NKVD National Operations: Under NKVD Order No. 00447 (“kulak operation”) and the “national operations” (Polish Order No. 00485, German Order No. 00439, Romanian, Harbinite, Latvian, Estonian, Finnish, Greek and Korean directives), ~1,57M people were arrested and 681 692 were executed in 1937-1938AD, striking disproportionately at borderland minorities in Regions 4, 7, 10, 14, 16, 17 and 45 and political exiles inside the Gulag [12][13].

Karelia (Region 16): Belomorcanal, "Karelian Fever", the 1940/1944 Evacuation of 422 000 Finnish Karelians, and the Karelo-Finnish SSR

Region 16 (337 469 km2) exemplifies the intersection of Gulag mega-projects, ethnic purges, border annexations and complete population replacement [14][73]. The White Sea-Baltic Canal (*Belomorcanal / BBK*, 1931-1933AD) and Kola Industrialisation: Constructed in twenty months (November 1931AD - August 1933AD) across 227 km from Lake Onega (Povenets) to the White Sea (Soroka/Belomorsk) by an average contingent of 107 900 *Belbaltlag* prisoners (with ~170k passing through the camp and ~12 000 to 25 000 officially recorded camp deaths), the canal was managed from Medvezhyegorsk (Region 16) [16][73]. *Belbaltlag* and *Segezhlag* subsequently built pulp-and-paper, aluminium and nickel complexes at Segezha, Nadvoitsy and Monchegorsk (*Severonikel* on the Kola Peninsula), while Murmansk expanded from 8 777 (1926AD) to 118 690 (1939AD), driving Region 16 from 860k (1926AD) to 1 390k (1939AD, including pre-war Finnish Viipuri/Vyborg province) (archived PDF) [14].

"Karelian Fever" (1930-1935AD) and the 1937-1938AD NKVD Finnish Operation: Recruited by Karelian ASSR leader Edvard Gylling to modernise Karelian forestry, ~6 000 to 6 500 North American Finns (from the United States and Canada) and ~8 000 Red Finns from Finland immigrated to Petrozavodsk, Kondopoga and Uroszero in the early 1930s. During the 1937-1938AD Great Terror, the NKVD executed Gylling, abolished Finnish national status in Karelia, and arrested or shot over 9 000 ethnic Finns in Karelia (~38% of all Great Terror victims in the republic despite Finns forming <3% of the population) [73].

The 1939-1940AD Winter War, the 1940/1944AD Evacuation of ~422 000 Finnish Karelians, and the Karelo-Finnish SSR (1940-1956AD): Following the Moscow Peace Treaty (12 March 1940AD), the USSR annexed the Karelian Isthmus (Viipuri / Vyborg), Ladoga Karelia (Sortavala, Kakisalmi/Priozersk, Suojarvi) and Salla (~35 000 km2) and elevated Karelia on 31 March 1940AD into the 16th Union Republic: the Karelo-Finnish SSR [4][73]. Virtually the entire indigenous Finnish Karelian population (~422 000 people, >99% of the ceded territory's inhabitants) evacuated across the new border into Finland in March 1940AD rather than remain under Soviet rule. After ~260 000 Karelians returned during the 1941-1944AD Continuation War, they evacuated a second and final time (~407 000 total evacuees) upon the September 1944AD Moscow Armistice, leaving Vyborg and Sortavala empty of their pre-war population. Consequently, Region 16 fell from 1 390k (1939AD) to 1 120k (1941AD) and 680k (1945AD, -39,3% below 1941AD), before organised kolkhoz and timber resettlement from Belarus, Vologda, Central Russia and Ukraine restored it to 1 120k by 1953AD [4].

Komi ASSR (Region 18), Volga-Kama ASSRs (Regions 23-24), and the Great Ural Arsenal (Region 34)

Across the northern and Volga-Ural autonomous republics of the RSFSR, Stalinist industrialisation and forced labour produced dramatic demographic transformations (Figure 4 and Table 1). Region 18 (Komi ASSR & Nenets National Okrug: Vorkutlag, Intalag, Ukhtpechlag, Sevzheldorlag): Elevated from the Komi (Zyryan) Autonomous Oblast to the Komi ASSR under the 5 December 1936AD Stalin Constitution, Region 18 more than tripled from 240k in 1926AD to 430k in 1939AD, 560k in 1945AD and 750k in 1953AD (+212,5% over 1926AD - the only European USSR region to expand continuously throughout the 1941-1945AD war!). Following the 1929AD OGPU Ukhta expedition, *Ukhtpechlag* (1932-1938AD) was split into *Vorkutlag* (mining Pechora coking coal at 67,5°N to replace occupied Donbas coal during the war), *Intalag* (Inta energy coal), *Ukhtizhemlag* (Ukhta oil and radium/gas) and *Sevzheldorlag* (which built the 1 191 km Kotlas-Pechora-Vorkuta North Pechora Railway, completed in December 1941AD at the cost of >30k prisoner lives) [13][16]. By 1953AD, Vorkuta (65k free residents plus 73k inmates in *Vorkutlag* and Special Camp No. 6 *Rechlag*, site of the July-August 1953AD Vorkuta Uprising, where Baltic and Western Ukrainian political prisoners played a leading role), Ukhta (26k), Inta (24k) and Pechora (22k) had reduced ethnic

Komi to a minority (~30%) inside their own republic.

Region 23 (Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian & Udmurt ASSRs + Gorky & Kirov): Grew from 6 770k (1926AD) to 7 280k (1941AD) and 6 950k (1953AD). In the Mordovian ASSR (1934AD), rural 1933AD famine and out-migration were offset by the massive *Temlag / Dubravlag* camp complex at Yavas and Potma (~50k+ prisoners, including Special Camp No. 3 for political prisoners from 1948AD); the Udmurt ASSR (1934AD) centred on Izhevsk (63k in 1926AD -> 176k in 1939AD -> 245k in 1953AD), which produced over 11,1M rifles and carbines during 1941-1945AD; Gorky (*GAZ* automotive plant) jumped from 222k (1926AD) to 644k (1939AD) and 830k (1953AD); and northern Kirov Oblast hosted *Vyatlag* (~30k+ timber prisoners, including 1941AD Latvian and Estonian deportees) (archived PDF) [13][74].

Region 24 (Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza) and Region 34 (Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR): In the Tatar ASSR (Kazan: 179k in 1926AD -> 398k in 1939AD -> 560k in 1953AD) and Bashkir ASSR (Ufa: 99k -> 250k -> 380k; Ishimbai, Tuymazy and Salavat/Novostroika), the discovery of the "Second Baku" (*Vtoroy Baku*) Volga-Ural oilfields (1932-1944AD) and the 1941-1942AD evacuation of 667+ defence factories transformed Region 34 from 9 100k (1926AD) to 11 900k (1941AD), 13 500k (1943AD) and 14 390k (1953AD, +58,1% over 1926AD), powered by ~350k+ mobilised Soviet German and minority *Trudarmiya* ("Labour Army") conscripts in Chelyabinsk (*Bakallag/Chelyabmetallurgstroy*), *Bogoslovlag* (Karpinsk/Krasnoturyinsk aluminium), *Tagillag* and Solikamsk (*Usollag*) (archived PDF) [75][76].

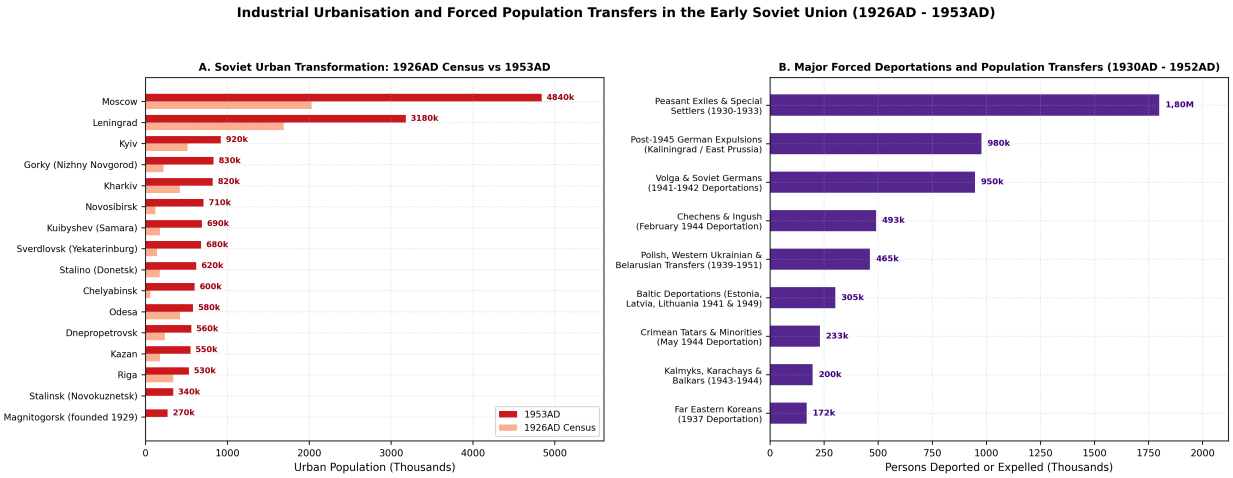


Figure 4. Urban population growth across major Soviet metropolises, industrial boomtowns, annexed ports, and Gulag centres at 1926AD, 1939AD, and 1953AD.

Wartime Ethnic Deportations and ASSR Liquidations (Regions 15, 26, 28, 30, 31, 32, and 33)

Between August 1941AD and June 1944AD, Stalin, Beria and the State Defence Committee (*GKO*) carried out seven total ethnic deportations (*totalnye deportatsii "nakazannykh narodov"*), abolishing five autonomous republics and autonomous oblasts across the Lower Volga, Crimea and the North Caucasus and deporting their entire indigenous populations in sealed cattle cars to special settlements (*spetsposeleniya*) in Kazakhstan, Central Asia and Siberia (archived PDF; archived PDF) [4][6][21][22][77][78]. Our 45-region partition explicitly isolates each liquidated autonomous unit (Regions 15, 26, 28, 30, 31, 32 and 33) (Figure 3, and Table 6).

Region 26: Volga German ASSR (Liquidated August-September 1941AD):

Under the Supreme Soviet Presidium Decree of 28 August 1941AD ("On the Resettlement of the Germans Living in the Volga Districts"), the Volga German ASSR (*ASSR Nemtsev Povolzhya*, founded 1918/1924AD with its capital at Engels/Pokrovsk and cantonal centres at Marxstadt/Marks, Balzer/Krasnoarmeysk, Seelmann/Rovnoe, Kukkus and Pallasovka) was abolished on 7 September 1941AD, and its 22 cantons were partitioned between Saratov Oblast (15 cantons) and Stalingrad Oblast (7 cantons) [4][43].

Between 3 and 20 September 1941AD, NKVD troops loaded 438 700 Volga Germans (virtually the entire ethnic German population of Region 26, alongside ~42k Germans from neighbouring Saratov and Stalingrad raions) into 188 freight echelons bound for Altai Krai (Region 38, ~95k), Novosibirsk and Omsk Oblasts (Region 35, ~195k), Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 40, ~75k) and the Kazakh SSR [43][77]. Combined with the 1941-1942AD deportation of >450k Soviet Germans from Ukraine, Crimea, Transcaucasia and Leningrad (~950k wartime deportees) and the conscription of ~316k adult German men and women into NKVD *Trudarmiya* timber and construction camps in Regions 18, 34 and 37, total wartime German forced displacement reached ~1,2M [6][22].

As a direct result, Region 26 plummeted by -66,1% from 620k in June 1941AD to 210k in 1943AD and 250k in 1945AD (-59,7%), recovering only to 340k by 1953AD (-45,2% below 1941AD) as evacuated and resettled Russian and Ukrainian collective farmers only partially refilled the depopulated German steppes.

Region 30: Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO (Liquidated November 1943AD) & Cherkess AO:

Following the Supreme Soviet Decree of 12 October 1943AD, on 2-5 November 1943AD NKVD units deported 14 774 families (69 267 persons) of the Karachay Autonomous Oblast (capital Mikoyan-Shakhar, renamed Klukhori/Karachaevsk) in 34 echelons to the Kazakh (45 529) and Kirghiz (23 300) SSRs, where ~15k to 19k (~22%, including over 10k children) perished from typhus and malnutrition during 1943-1945AD [21][78].

The Karachay AO was abolished: its northern districts were absorbed into Stavropol Krai and the Cherkess AO, while its southern high-mountain Caucasus districts (Mikoyan-Shakhar and Uchkulan) were annexed to the Georgian SSR as Klukhorsky Raion until 1955AD [79]. Combined with wartime losses across Stavropol, Region 30 fell by -16,7% from 1 740k (1941AD) to 1 450k (1945AD).

Region 28: Kalmyk ASSR (Liquidated December 1943AD, Operation *Ulusy*):

Under the Supreme Soviet Decree of 27 December 1943AD, NKVD Chief Beria supervised Operation *Ulusy* (28-31 December 1943AD), in which 10 000 NKVD troops deported 26 359 Kalmyk families (93 139 persons, followed by ~6k Kalmyks from Rostov and Stalingrad oblasts and demobilised Red Army soldiers sent to the *Shirokovlag* hydro-camp) in 46 unheated winter cattle-car echelons to Altai Krai (Region 38), Omsk, Tyumen and Novosibirsk Oblasts (Regions 35-36) and Krasnoyarsk Krai (Regions 40-41), with ~3 500 Kalmyks sent in 1944AD to Far Eastern fishery brigades on Sakhalin and the Tatar Strait (Region 45) [4][21][77]. Over 16 500 Kalmyks (>17% of the deported nation) died in transit and during 1944-1945AD.

The Kalmyk ASSR was abolished, its capital Elista was renamed Stepnoy, and its territory was partitioned among Astrakhan, Stalingrad and Rostov Oblasts and Stavropol Krai, causing Region 28 to plunge by -64,9% from 185k (1941AD) to 65k (1945AD), reaching only 100k by 1953AD (-45,9% below 1941AD).

Region 32: Chechen-Ingush ASSR -> Grozny Oblast (Liquidated February-March 1944AD, Operation *Chechevitsa*):

Under GKO Resolution No. 5073ss (31 January 1944AD), Beria, Kobulov, Serov and 119 000 NKVD/SMERSH troops launched Operation *Chechevitsa* ("Lentil") at dawn on 23 February 1944AD (Red Army Day) [4][21][22]. Using ~12 000 Lend-Lease Studebaker trucks to clear snowbound mountain *auls* and 180 freight echelons (14 200 wagons), the NKVD deported 478 479 Vainakhs (387 229 Chechens and 91 250 Ingush) within seven days; including Chechens and Ingush deported from other republics and demobilised from the Red Army, the total registered contingent reached 493 269 to 496 460 [6][21]. In the high-mountain

village of Khaibakh (Galanchozhsky Raion), on 27 February 1944AD, NKVD officers under M. Gveshiani locked ~650 to 700 women, children and elderly residents unable to march through deep snow inside a collective-farm stable and burned them alive [4].

Deported to the Kazakh SSR (~411k) and Kirghiz SSR (~85k), the Chechens and Ingush suffered catastrophic typhus, exposure and starvation mortality: NKVD special-settlement records document 123 000 to 144 704 deaths between 1944AD and 1948AD (23,7% to 25,0% of the entire Chechen and Ingush nations) [6][78].

On 7 March 1944AD, the Chechen-Ingush ASSR was abolished and dismembered into four pieces: (a) the central and northern plains around Grozny and the Sunzha/Terek valleys became Grozny Oblast of the RSFSR; (b) Prigorodny Raion (East Vladikavkaz), Nazran, Malgobek and Achkhoy-Martan were transferred to the North Ossetian ASSR (Region 31, with Vladikavkaz/Ordzhonikidze renamed Dzaudzhikau); (c) the eastern mountain districts (Vedeno, Nozhay-Yurt, Sayasan, Kurchaloy, Cheberloy, Sharoy) were annexed to the Dagestan ASSR (Region 33); and (d) the southern Itum-Kale gorge was annexed to the Georgian SSR (Akhalkhevi Raion) [79]. Despite organised Slavic resettlement into the Grozny oilfields and Sunzha valley, Region 32 collapsed by -57,0% from 790k (1941AD) to 340k (1945AD), reaching only 490k in 1953AD (-38,0% below 1941AD).

Region 31: Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (March 1944AD Balkar Deportation) & North Ossetian ASSR:

On 8-9 March 1944AD, immediately after Operation *Chechevitsa*, 19 000 NKVD troops deported the entire Balkar population (37 713 persons) from the high-mountain Baksan, Chegem, Cherek and Khulam-Bezengi gorges in 14 echelons to Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan (~22% died in 1944-1948AD) [21][78].

By Decree of 8 April 1944AD, the republic was renamed the Kabardian ASSR (capital Nalchik), and its upper Baksan and Mount Elbrus territories were ceded to the Georgian SSR (Upper Svanetia). Meanwhile, the North Ossetian ASSR absorbed Ingush Prigorodny Raion and was resettled with ~45k Ossetians from both North Ossetia and South Ossetia/Georgia, resulting in Region 31 declining by -18,3% from 930k (1941AD) to 760k (1945AD) before recovering to 930k by 1953AD [79].

Region 33: Dagestan ASSR (February-May 1944AD Aukhovsky Chechen Deportation & Forced Mountain Resettlements):

During Operation *Chechevitsa* (23-29 February 1944AD), the NKVD also deported the entire Aukhovsky (Akkin) Chechen population (14 542 persons) from Aukhovsky Raion (founded October 1943AD in northwestern Dagestan around Khasavyurt) to Kazakhstan (archived PDF) [34][79].

To erase Chechen presence and secure the annexed eastern Chechen mountain districts (Vedeno, Nozhay-Yurt, Sayasan, Kurchaloy), Sovnarkom Resolution No. 255-74ss (11 March 1944AD) ordered the compulsory internal resettlement of ~55 000 to 65 000 Dagestani highlanders: Aukhovsky Raion was renamed Novolaksky Raion and forcibly settled with ~6 000 to 8 000 mountain Laks from Kuli and Laksky raions (Kazi-Kumukh), while ~50 000 Avars, Andi-Tsez peoples and Dargins were marched from central Dagestan into the vacated Chechen villages (renamed Andalal, Rikvani, Ritlyab and Shuragatl). Lacking shelter, tools or immunity to lowland malaria and typhus, up to 15-20% of the forcibly resettled Dagestani mountaineers perished between 1944AD and 1947AD, contributing (alongside heavy wartime military losses) to Region 33 falling by -20,9% from 860k (1941AD) to 680k (1945AD, 760k in 1953AD) [34].

Region 15: Crimean ASSR -> Crimean Oblast (May-June 1944AD Crimean Tatar & Minority Deportations):

Following the liberation of Sevastopol, GKO Resolution No. 5859ss (11 May 1944AD) ordered the total deportation of the Crimean Tatars [4][21]. On 18-20 May 1944AD, 32 000 NKVD troops deported 191 044 Crimean Tatars (47 000 families, including ~6k deported from the Kerch peninsula in April) in 67 echelons to the Uzbek SSR (151 604), the Mari ASSR (Region 23, ~8,5k), Molotov and Sverdlovsk Oblasts (Region 34, ~20k) and Kostroma/Gorky timber camps, where ~27k to 44k (15-22%) died during 1944-1948AD [6][22].

Five weeks later, under GKO Resolution No. 5984ss (2 June 1944AD), on 24-27 June 1944AD the NKVD deported ~41 854 additional Crimean minorities: 15 040 Crimean Greeks, 12 422 Bulgarians, 9 621 Armenians and ~4 770 Germans, Italians and foreign nationals (following the August 1941AD deportation of ~53 000 Crimean Germans). Combined with the 250-day Siege of Sevastopol (1941-1942AD) and the Nazi murder of ~40 000 Crimean Jews and Krymchaks, Region 15 collapsed by -49,2% from 1 180k (1941AD) to 600k (1945AD). On 30 June 1945AD, the Crimean ASSR was downgraded to Crimean Oblast, Tatar, Greek and German toponyms (*Karasubazar* -> Belogorsk) were Russified, and organised kolkhoz resettlement brought >350 000 Russian and Ukrainian settlers from Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Bryansk, Rostov, Gorky and Ukraine, raising Region 15 to 980k by 1953AD (still -16,9% below 1941AD) [4].

Liquidated ASSR / Borderland & Region	Date	Deported Headcount	1941 -> 1945 -> 1953	Exile Destinations, Excess Mortality & Territorial Liquidation
Reg. 26: Volga German ASSR (Engels, Marxstadt, Balzer)	Aug-Sept 1941AD	438 700 (950k+ all USSR)	620k -> 250k -> 340k	To Altai (Reg. 38), Novosibirsk/Omsk (Reg. 35), Krasnoyarsk (Reg. 40) & Kazakhstan; ASSR split between Saratov & Stalingrad; 316k in Trudarmiya
Reg. 30: Karachay AO in Stavropol Krai (Mikoyan-Shakhar)	2-5 Nov 1943AD	69 267 Karachays	1 740k -> 1 450k -> 1 700k	To Kazakh & Kirghiz SSRs (22% died 1943-45); AO abolished, southern mountain gorges ceded to Georgian SSR as Klukhorsky Raion
Reg. 28: Kalmyk ASSR (Elista -> Stepnoy, Operation Ulusy)	28-31 Dec 1943AD	93 139 Kalmyks (+6k)	185k -> 65k -> 100k	To Altai (Reg. 38), Omsk/ Novosibirsk (Reg. 35), Krasnoyarsk (Reg. 40) & Sakhalin fisheries (>17% died); ASSR absorbed into Astrakhan Oblast
Reg. 32: Chechen-Ingush ASSR -> Grozny Oblast (Op. Chechevitsa)	23-29 Feb 1944AD	493 269 Chechens & Ingush	790k -> 340k -> 490k	To Kazakh (411k) & Kirghiz (85k) SSRs (24% died, >123k deaths + Khaibakh massacre); ASSR split into Grozny Oblast, Prigorodny (N. Ossetia) & Dagestan
Reg. 31: Kabardino-Balkar ASSR -> Kabardian ASSR (Nalchik)	8-9 Mar 1944AD	37 713 Balkars	930k -> 760k -> 930k	To Kazakh & Kirghiz SSRs (22% died); renamed Kabardian ASSR; upper Baksan & Mount Elbrus ceded to Georgian SSR
Reg. 33: Dagestan ASSR (Aukhovsky Raion -> Novolaksky Raion)	Feb-May 1944AD	14 542 Akkin (+55k moved)	860k -> 680k -> 760k	Akkin Chechens deported to Kazakhstan; 6k Laks moved into Novolaksky Raion & 50k Avars/Dargins into annexed Chechen mountain raions

(Continued from previous page)

Liquidated ASSR / Borderland & Region	Date	Deported Headcount	1941 -> 1945 -> 1953	Exile Destinations, Excess Mortality & Territorial Liquidation
Reg. 15: Crimean ASSR -> Crimean Oblast (Simferopol, Bakhchisaray)	May-June 1944AD	191 044 Tatars + 41 854 min.	1 180k -> 600k -> 980k	Tatars, Greeks (15,0k), Bulgarians (12,4k) & Armenians (9,6k) to Uzbekistan, Mari ASSR & Urals; downgraded to Crimean Oblast; >350k Slavic settlers in
Reg. 45: Primorye & Far East Border Zone (Soviet Koreans)	Sept-Oct 1937AD	171 781 Soviet Koreans	2 560k -> 2 790k -> 3 640k	124 echelons from Vladivostok/Posyet to Uzbekistan (76,5k) & Kazakhstan (95,3k); border kolkhozes repopulated by Red Army settlers
Reg. 16 & 17: Leningrad & Karelia (Ingrian Finns & Karelians)	1935-44AD	89k Ingrian + 422k evacuated	Reg. 16: 1 120k -> 680k -> 1 120k	Ingrian Finns deported to Yakutia (Lena Delta, Reg. 43) & Siberia; 422k Finnish Karelians evacuated to Finland in 1940/1944; Karelo-Finnish SSR repopulated
Reg. 1-4: Baltic SSRs & Moldavian SSR (1941 + Vesna/Priboi/ Yug)	1941 & 1948-51AD	66k (1941) + 232k (1948-51)	Reg. 1-4: 8 464k -> 6 974k -> 8 300k	Vesna (40-48k LT), Priboi (20,7k EE + 42,1k LV + 29,2k LT), Yug (35,8k MD) & Osen (16,2k LT) deported to Irkutsk, Krasnoyarsk, Omsk, Tomsk, Amur & Kurgan
Reg. 6, 8 & 9: W. Belarus, Galicia-Volhynia & Bukovina (OUN-UPA)	1940-41 & 44-52AD	320k (1940-41) + 203k OUN	Reg. 8: 7 740k -> 5 180k -> 5 660k	Polish citizens deported 1940-41; 1,08M Poles exchanged 1944-46; 203k W. Ukrainians deported to Siberia/Vorkuta/Kolyma (Op. Zapad 1947)
Total Punished Peoples & Special Settlers (1937-1953AD)	1937-1953AD	3,55M ethnic/ border exiles	2 753 356 in exile (Jan 1953)	On 1 Jan 1953AD, MVD special settlements held 2 753 356 exiles (1 224 931 Germans, 498 452 N. Caucasians, 204 698 Crimean, 175 063 OUN, 173k Baltic/MD)

Table 6. Total ethnic deportations, liquidated autonomous republics, western borderland operations, and regional trajectories from 1937AD to 1953AD.

Siberian Republics, Polar Gulag, and the Great Patriotic War (1941AD - 1953AD)

Disaggregated Siberian Regions (Regions 35-45): Trans-Siberian Industrial Spine vs Special-Settlement Taiga, Polar Gulag, and Indigenous Republics

A crucial feature of our 45-region partition is the disaggregation of Siberia and the Far East into eleven distinct regions (Regions 35-45, 12 853 253 km2) that separate the rapidly urbanising Trans-Siberian industrial and evacuation corridor (Regions 35, 37, 38, 40, 45) from the northern special-settlement and polar Gulag zones (Regions 36, 41, 44) and the indigenous Siberian autonomous republics and oblasts (Regions 39, 42, 43) (Table 7).

Region 43: Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, the 1942AD Churapcha Tragedy, and Arctic Lena Delta Exiles):

Spanning 3,06M km2, the Yakut ASSR grew from 285k in 1926AD to 415k in 1939AD and 425k in 1941AD as the Aldan (Nezametny) and Allakh-Yun (*Dzhugdzhurlag*) goldfields drew tens of thousands of Russian miners and special settlers, reducing the indigenous Sakha (Yakut) share of the republic's population from 81,6% (1926AD) to 56,5% (1939AD) [80].

During the Great Patriotic War, Region 43 contracted from 425k (1941AD) to 400k (1943-1945AD) due to heavy military conscription (~62k mobilised), rural famine and the August-September 1942AD Churapcha Tragedy (*Churapchinskaya tragediya*) [80]: under the Yakut VKP(b) Obkom resolution of 11 August 1942AD (signed by I. Vinokurov), 4 988 Sakha collective farmers (1 781 households from 41 drought-stricken *alaas* cattle-breeding kolkhozes in Churapcha Ulus) were forcibly marched to the Lena River and shipped by barge 1 500+ km north of the Arctic Circle to unprepared fishing camps in Kobyaysky (2 023), Zhigansky (1 178) and Bulunsky (1 787) uluses to supply fish for the front. Stripped of livestock and dumped onto freezing tundra without nets, winter housing or rations, 1 748 Churapcha deportees (>35% of the resettled population) perished from starvation and scurvy between 1942AD and 1944AD before the survivors were permitted to return in 1944-1946AD [80].

Concurrently, in 1942AD, the NKVD deported ~12 000 Leningrad Ingrian Finns (evacuated across Lake Ladoga from Region 17), Volga Germans (Region 26) and June 1941AD Lithuanian deportees (Region 3) to the treeless islands of the Arctic Lena Delta (Trofimovsk, Bykov Mys, Tit-Ary, Stolbovoy at 72-73°N), where ice-block barracks and scurvy killed over 40% of the exiles during the winter of 1942-1943AD [4][80]. Post-war expansion of *Yanastroy*/*Dalstroy* tin and gold camps at Ust-Nera (Oymyakon) and Khandyga raised Region 43 to 470k by 1953AD.

Region 42: Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937AD Territorial Dismemberment) & Chita/Transbaikalia (*Bamlag*):

In the Buryat-Mongol ASSR (founded 1923AD, capital Verkhneudinsk, renamed Ulan-Ude in 1934AD), brutal cattle collectivisation and anti-Buddhist terror (1929-1932AD, which destroyed >60% of the republic's livestock and closed all 44 *datsans*) provoked armed uprisings in Mukhorshibir, Bichura and Zakamensk and the flight of ~35 000 Buryats and Transbaikal Old Believers (*Semeiskie*) across the border into Mongolia and Manchuria.

At the height of the Great Terror, on 26 September 1937AD, the Central Executive Committee of the USSR dismembered the Buryat-Mongol ASSR, detaching six western Buryat *aimaks* (Alarsky, Bokhansky, Ekhirit-Bulagatsky, Nukutsky) into Irkutsk Oblast (Region 40) as the Ust-Orda Buryat National Okrug and two eastern *aimaks* (Aginsky, Ulan-Ononsky) into Chita Oblast as the Agin-Buryat National Okrug, while NKVD officers executed First Secretary Mikhey Yerbanov and the Buryat intellectual elite on charges of "Pan-Mongolist Japanese espionage" [12].

Simultaneously, Five-Year-Plan construction of the giant Ulan-Ude Locomotive and Wagon Works

(*UULVRZ*) and Aircraft Plant No. 99 propelled Ulan-Ude from 28 918 (1926AD) to 125 690 (1939AD) and 158 000 (1953AD), while NKVD *Dzhidlag* prisoners (joined in 1948AD by Lithuanian Operation *Vesna* timber exiles) mined strategic tungsten and molybdenum at Gorodok (Zakamensk) and *Bamlag*/*Zabaikallag* prisoners expanded the Transbaikal railway and gold/tin mines across Chita Oblast, carrying Region 42 from 1 050k (1926AD) to 1 970k (1953AD, +87,6%).

Region 39: Oyrot/Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO (Kulak Mines), Minusinsk & Tuva AO (October 1944AD Annexation):

Across the Altai-Sayan autonomous belt (Region 39: 490k in 1926AD -> 960k in 1953AD, +95,9%), the Khakass Autonomous Oblast (established 20 October 1930AD, capital Abakan: 3,1k in 1926AD -> 36,6k in 1939AD -> 52k in 1953AD) became a major reception zone for dekulakised peasants (1930-1933AD), Volga Germans (1941AD), Kalmyks (1944AD) and Baltic/Western Ukrainian deportees (1944-1949AD) in the Chernogorsk coal basin and *Balyksinsk*/*Sarala* goldfields, reducing ethnic Khakass from 53,0% (1926AD) to 16,8% (1939AD) of their oblast's population.

In the Oyrot Autonomous Oblast (founded 1922AD), collectivisation and the 1933AD famine triggered flight into Xinjiang; on 7 January 1948AD, during late Stalinist ideological campaigns against "bourgeois-nationalist Oyrot epics", the oblast was renamed Gorno-Altai Autonomous Oblast and its capital *Oyrot-Tura* became Gorno-Altaysk.

On 11 October 1944AD, the formerly independent Tuvan People's Republic (*Tannu-Tuva*, 170 500 km2, capital Kyzyl, population ~95 000, ~81% Tuvan nomadic herders plus Russian settlers) was secretly annexed by Presidium Decree as the Tuva Autonomous Oblast of the RSFSR, followed by forced collectivisation of Tuvan *arats* during 1948-1953AD [4].

Regions 35, 37, 38, 40, 41, 44 and 45: Trans-Siberian Industrial Hubs, Kuzbass, Altai Deportees, Polar Norillag, Dalstroy Kolyma and Southern Far East:

Region 35 (West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine: Tyumen, Kurgan, Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk) rose from 3 880k (1926AD) to 5 080k (1941AD), surged to 5 880k (1943AD) as 322+ evacuated defence and optical/aviation plants settled in Novosibirsk (120k -> 404k -> 710k) and Omsk (162k -> 289k -> 490k), absorbed tens of thousands of Estonian, Latvian and Moldavian *Priboi*/*Yug* deportees in 1949AD across Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk, Kurgan and Tyumen, and reached 6 340k in 1953AD (+63,4%) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [18][35][81].

Region 37 (Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag: Kemerovo Oblast, detached 26 January 1943AD) more than tripled from 750k (1926AD) to 1 820k (1941AD), 2 150k (1943AD) and 2 520k (1953AD, +236,0%), anchored by Stalinsk/Novokuznetsk (3,9k -> 166k -> 315k), Prokopyevsk (11k -> 107k -> 240k) and Kemerovo (22k -> 133k -> 235k), while assimilating ~78k *Siblag* prisoners, >100k Volga German *Trudarmiya* coal miners and the liquidated Mountain Shoria (*Gornaya Shoriya*) National Raion (abolished 1939AD, where Shor iron-smelters fell from >50% to <6%).

Region 38 (Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub: Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Biysk, Slavgorod) grew from 2 280k (1926AD) to 2 680k (1941AD), jumped to 3 050k (1943AD) with the arrival of ~95k deported Volga Germans, ~22k Kalmyks, 1941AD Lithuanian and 1949AD Moldavian exiles, Leningrad evacuees and the evacuated Kharkiv Tractor Plant at Rubtsovsk (*Altai Tractor Plant*), and reached 3 240k in 1953AD (+42,1%) (archived PDF) [82].

Region 40 (East Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Krasnoyarsk *Kraslag* & Irkutsk-Tayshet *Ozerlag*) more than doubled from 1 920k (1926AD) to 3 950k (1953AD, +105,7%), receiving the largest concentrations of 1948-1951AD Lithuanian, Estonian and Western Ukrainian deportees alongside MVD Special Camp No. 7 (*Ozerlag* at Tayshet, ~37k political prisoners) and *Angarstroy* (115k prisoners) building the western Baikal-Amur Mainline and early Angarsk (archived PDF; archived PDF) [63][77].

Region 41 (Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag & Tundra: Norillag, Igarka, Taymyr & Evenkia) surged by +354,5% from 110k (1926AD) to 500k (1953AD). Centred on Norilsk (69,3°N), *Norillag* (1935-1956AD, 72 500 inmates plus Special Camp No. 2 *Gorlag*, where Baltic and Ukrainian political prisoners spearheaded the May-August 1953AD Norilsk Uprising) produced over 35% of Soviet nickel alongside copper, cobalt and platinum, while ~25k kulak and Lithuanian/Finnish exiles worked at Igarka and in the Taymyr (Dolgan-Nenets) and Evenki National Okrugs (founded December 1930AD) [13][16].

Region 44 (Dalstroy Extreme Northeast Gulag Complex: Kolyma-Magadan *Sevvostlag*, Chukotka & Kamchatka) expanded twelvefold (+1 100,0%!) from 35k (1926AD) to 255k (1941AD) and 420k (1953AD, detached as Magadan Oblast in December 1953AD). Established in November 1931AD under Eduard Berzin, the NKVD *Dalstroy* trust and *Sevvostlag* (~170k-200k peak inmates, plus Special Camp No. 5 *Berlag*) shipped ~740 000 prisoners by steamer from Vladivostok/Nakhodka to Nagaevo Bay (Magadan, 55k in 1953AD) to build the 2 000 km Kolyma Highway and mine gold, tin and uranium at Susuman, Yagodnoye, Butugychag and Pevek (Chaun-Chukotka), at the cost of ~130 000 to 150 000 prisoner deaths [13][16].

Region 45 (Southern Far East: Amur, Jewish AO *Birobidzhan*, Khabarovsk, Primorye & 1945 South Sakhalin/Kurils) grew more than threefold (+256,9%) from 1 020k (1926AD) to 2 560k (1941AD) and 3 640k (1953AD), receiving ~17k Latvian *Priboi* deportees in Amur Oblast (1949AD) alongside *Bamlag* (260k prisoners at Svobodny), Komsomolsk-on-Amur (0,3k -> 71k -> 160k), the Jewish Autonomous Oblast (Birobidzhan, established 7 May 1934AD, 108,9k in 1939AD) and post-August 1945AD Southern Sakhalin (*Karafuto* -> Yuzhno-Sakhalinsk) and the Kurils, where ~290 000 to 400 000 Japanese civilians were repatriated (1946-1949AD, leaving ~28k-43k stateless Sakhalin Koreans) and replaced by >350 000 Soviet settlers [4][12][18].

Siberian / Far East Region & Autonomous Unit	1926AD	1939AD	1945AD	1953AD	1926-53	Key Gulag Complexes, Deportee Inflows & Indigenous Republic Shocks
Reg. 35: W. Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk, Kurgan)	3 880k	4 820k	5 550k	6 340k	+63,4%	322+ evacuated plants; 195k Volga German/ Kalmyk & 1949 Estonian/Latvian/ Moldavian Priboi-Yug exiles
Reg. 36: Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/ Nazino, Yugra, Yamal)	360k	680k	750k	820k	+127,8%	265k kulak exiles in Narym & Ostyak-Vogul/Yamal Okrugs (1930); May 1933 Nazino tragedy (>4k died)
Reg. 37: Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo Oblast 1943AD)	750k	1 680k	2 050k	2 520k	+236,0%	Stalinsk (315k), Prokopyevsk (240k), Kemerovo (235k); Siblag (78k), Trudarmiya; Mountain Shoria AO liquidated

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Siberian / Far East Region & Autonomous Unit	1926AD	1939AD	1945AD	1953AD	1926-53	Key Gulag Complexes, Deportee Inflows & Indigenous Republic Shocks
Reg. 38: Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	2 280k	2 560k	2 860k	3 240k	+42,1%	Received 95k Volga Germans, 22k Kalmyks, 1941/49 Baltic-Moldavian exiles & Rubtsovsk/ Barnaul plants
Reg. 39: Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO & Tuva AO (1944AD Annex.)	490k	740k	810k	960k	+95,9%	Khakassia kulak/ German mines; Oyrot AO renamed Gorno-Altai AO (1948); Tannu-Tuva annexed Oct 1944 (95k)
Reg. 40: E. Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	1 920k	2 880k	3 320k	3 950k	+105,7%	Kraslag & Irkutsk timber exiles (1948-51 Vesna/Priboi); Tayshet Ozerlag (37k) & Angarstroy (115k)
Reg. 41: Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka & Evenkia	110k	260k	390k	500k	+354,5%	Norillag/Gorlag (72,5k inmates, 1953 uprising) built Norilsk (78k); Igarka Lithuanian/Finnish exiles
Reg. 42: Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/ Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	1 050k	1 640k	1 680k	1 970k	+87,6%	1929-32 flight; Sept 1937 split of Ust-Orda & Agin-Buryat Okrugs; Dzhidlag tungsten; Ulan-Ude 158k
Reg. 43: Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta)	285k	415k	400k	470k	+64,9%	Aldan gold; Aug 1942 Churapcha tragedy (1 748 of 4 988 Sakha died in Arctic); Lena Delta Finnish/Baltic exiles
Reg. 44: Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan, Chukotka, Kamchatka	35k	205k	320k	420k	+1100,0%	Dalstroy/Sevvostlag (740k shipped, 140k died) built Magadan (55k), Kolyma Highway, Susuman & Pevek

(Continued from previous page)

Siberian / Far East Region & Autonomous Unit	1926AD	1939AD	1945AD	1953AD	1926-53	Key Gulag Complexes, Deportee Inflows & Indigenous Republic Shocks
Reg. 45: S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937) & S. Sakhalin	1 020k	2 240k	2 790k	3 640k	+256,9%	171,8k Koreans deported (1937); Birobidzhan Jewish AO (1934); 1949 Latvian Priboi in Amur; S. Sakhalin (1945)
Total Siberian & Far Eastern Belt (Regions 35-45 Combined)	12 180k	18 120k	20 920k	24 830k	+103,9%	Doubled from 12,18M (1926AD) to 24,83M (1953AD) via Five-Year-Plan industry, evacuation, Gulag & exile

Table 7. Demographic trajectories, Gulag complexes, special settlements, and indigenous autonomous shifts across the eleven Siberian regions (1926AD - 1953AD).

The Great Patriotic War (1941-1945AD), the Holocaust, Refined Leningrad Siege Zone (Region 17), and the 1946-1947AD Famine

Across the western and southern regions of our 45-region partition (Regions 1-17, 21, 22, 27 and 29), the Great Patriotic War (1941-1945AD), the Holocaust, post-war population exchanges (1944-1948AD) and the 1946-1947AD famine left deep, lasting demographic scars (Table 8). Byelorussian SSR (Region 6: Western Belarus & Region 7: Eastern BSSR): Occupied from June 1941AD to July 1944AD, Belarus lost 2,2M to 2,5M inhabitants (~25% of its population), including ~750k to 800k Jews murdered in the Minsk Ghetto (~100k), Maly Trostenets, Brest/Bronnaya Gora (~50k), Grodno, Pinsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev and Gomel, and 628 villages (such as Khatyn) burned with all inhabitants (archived PDF; archived PDF) [23][37][83]. Region 7 fell by -28,5% from 5 850k (1941AD) to 4 180k (1945AD, 4 890k in 1953AD), while Region 6 dropped by -28,1% from 2 950k (1941AD) to 2 120k (1945AD, 2 310k in 1953AD) as ~274 200 ethnic Poles were transferred to Poland under the 1944-1946AD Lublin treaties.

Ukrainian SSR (Regions 8-14): Combined population across Ukrainian Regions 8-15 plunged by -11 410k (-27,5%) from 41 560k (1941AD) to 30 150k (1945AD), driven by ~6,8M to 8,0M war deaths (including ~1,5M to 1,6M Holocaust victims at Babyn Yar in Kyiv 33 771, Kamianets-Podilskyi 23 600, Lviv/Janowska & Belzec, Drobytsky Yar in Kharkiv, and Romanian-occupied Odesa/Transnistria), 2,4M *Ostarbeiter* deportations and eastern evacuation (archived PDF) [23][41][84]. In Region 8 (Galicia & Volhynia: 7 740k in 1941AD -> 5 180k in 1945AD, -33,1%), the Holocaust (~700k murdered) was followed by the 1944-1946AD Polish-Ukrainian population exchange (~810 000 Poles transferred from Western Ukraine to Poland and ~482 800 Ukrainians transferred from Poland into Ukraine, plus ~140k Ukrainians deported inside Poland during 1947AD *Operation Vistula*) and the NKVD deportation of ~203 000 Western Ukrainians accused of aiding the OUN-UPA insurgency (culminating in Operation *Zapad* in October 1947AD, which exiled 77 791 people in three days to Karaganda, Omsk, Kemerovo and Vorkuta) [4][6][28]. In Region 9 (Northern Bukovina, Budjak & Transcarpathia: 2 780k in 1941AD -> 1 920k in 1945AD), Transcarpathia (Zakarpattia / Uzhhorod) was ceded by Czechoslovakia on 29 June 1945AD [4].

Refined Region 17 (Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod, and Pskov Oblasts): Separated cleanly from Kaliningrad Oblast (Region 5), Region 17 isolates the pure demographic shock of the 872-day Siege of Leningrad (8 September 1941AD - 27 January 1944AD) and the scorched-earth Wehrmacht occupation of Novgorod and Pskov (archived PDF; archived PDF) [85][86][87]. Between September 1941AD and January 1944AD, 800 000 to 1 000 000 civilians starved or froze to death inside Leningrad while 1,74M residents (including ~89k Leningrad Germans and Ingrian Finns deported to Siberia and the Lena Delta) were evacuated across Lake Ladoga's *Road of Life*, shrinking the city from 3,19M (1939AD) to 546k in January 1944AD (920k by late 1945AD), while Novgorod (40k in 1939AD -> fewer than 3k civilians at liberation in January 1944AD, 19k in 1945AD) and Staraya Russa were reduced to rubble. Consequently, Region 17 plunged by -56,5% from 6 960k in June 1941AD to 3 030k in 1943AD, recovering via re-evacuation and the 1944-1945AD border transfers of Ivangorod/Pechory (from Estonia) and Pytalovo/Abrene (from Latvia) to 4 340k in 1945AD (-37,6%) and 5 490k in 1953AD (still -21,1% below 1941AD, further battered politically during the 1949-1950AD "Leningrad Affair").

Frontline Russian Regions 21, 22, 27 and 29 and the 1946-1947AD Post-War Famine: Along the Smolensk-Rzhev-Vyazma-Bryansk axis, Region 21 (Upper Volga & Western Front) dropped by -25,8% (13 280k in 1941AD -> 9 850k in 1945AD, 10 790k in 1953AD); Region 22 (Central Black-Earth Belt: Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol) fell by -25,3% (13 850k -> 10 350k); and Region 27 (Saratov, Stalingrad & Astrakhan) fell by -19,3% (4 250k -> 3 430k, with Stalingrad reduced from 445k to 32k in February 1943AD). Immediately after the war, the severe 1946AD drought across Moldavia, Ukraine, the Central Black-Earth Belt, the Lower Volga and West Siberia - compounded by 17,5M tonnes of state grain procurements, grain exports and the September 1946AD removal of 27,5M rural inhabitants from state bread rationing - triggered the 1946-1947AD Soviet Famine (1,0M to 1,5M total excess deaths: 115k-200k in the Moldavian SSR Region 4 [2 080k in 1945AD -> 1 940k in 1947AD], ~300k-500k across Ukraine Regions 9, 10, 11 and 14 [Region 11: 6 750k -> 6 720k], and ~500k-700k across Russia Regions 21, 22, 27, 29, 35 and 38 [Region 22: 10 350k -> 10 250k]) before late Stalinist demographic recovery carried the 45-region total to 165 350k in March 1953AD (archived PDF; archived PDF) [26][27][67][81][82].

Wartime Front / Annexation / Famine Zone	**1941AD**	**1943AD**	**1945AD**	**1953AD**	**Major Wartime Shocks, Holocaust, Population Exchanges & Post-War Famine**
Reg. 1-3: Baltic SSRs (Estonia, Latvia & Lithuania)	5 994k	5 380k	4 894k	5 780k	266k Jews murdered (Ponary, 9th Fort, Rumbula); 270k fled West; 185k Vilnius Poles out; 196k exiled (1948-51)
Reg. 4 & 5: Moldavian SSR (1947 Famine) & Kaliningrad Oblast	3 690k	3 270k	2 260k	3 060k	200-280k Bessarabian/ Transnistrian Shoah; 115-200k Moldavian famine deaths (1 940k in 1947); 102,4k Germans out of Reg. 5
Reg. 6 & 7: Byelorussian SSR (Western & Eastern Belarus)	8 800k	6 500k	6 300k	7 200k	2,2-2,5M dead (25%); 628 villages burned (Khatyn); 800k Jews murdered; 274,2k Poles transferred to Poland

(Continued from previous page)

Wartime Front / Annexation / Famine Zone	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD	Major Wartime Shocks, Holocaust, Population Exchanges & Post-War Famine
Reg. 8 & 9: Western Ukraine (Galicia, Volhynia, Bukovina, Transcarpathia)	10 520k	8 200k	7 100k	7 750k	700k Jews murdered; 810k Poles out / 482,8k Ukrainians in; 203k OUN-UPA deportees; Transcarpathia annexed 1945
Reg. 10 & 11: Right-Bank & Left-Bank Ukraine (Kyiv, Kharkiv, Poltava)	16 830k	12 990k	12 700k	14 080k	Babyn Yar (33 771 shot Sept 1941), Drobytsky Yar; heavy Ostarbeiter deportations; 1946-47 famine in Reg. 10-11
Reg. 12, 13 & 14: Dnieper Bend, Donbas & Black Sea Steppe (Odesa)	13 030k	9 260k	9 750k	12 670k	1941 factory evacuation; Romanian Transnistria (240k Shoah deaths in Reg. 10/14); Donbas rebuilt to 5 420k (+1,9%)
Reg. 17: Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts	6 960k	3 030k	4 340k	5 490k	800k-1,0M Leningrad blockade deaths + 1,74M evacuated (-56,5% by 1943); Novgorod/Pskov ruin; Pechory/Pytalovo added
Reg. 21 & 22: Western Front (Smolensk, Rzhev) & Central Black-Earth	27 130k	20 600k	20 200k	21 940k	Catastrophic combat/ occupation ruin at Smolensk, Rzhev, Vyazma, Bryansk, Oryol & Voronezh; 1947 famine drop
Reg. 27 & 29: Stalingrad Front, Lower Volga, Rostov & Kuban	11 490k	9 300k	9 530k	11 160k	Battle of Stalingrad (445k -> 32k in Feb 1943); Zmievskaya Balka Shoah (27k in Rostov); Kuban front
Reg. 25 & 34: Kuibyshev Wartime Capital & Great Ural Arsenal	16 050k	17 950k	16 900k	19 070k	Received >800 evacuated factories & >2,5M evacuees; Tankograd (Chelyabinsk), Uralmash, Tagil & Kuibyshev boomed
All 45 Regions Combined (incl. 146 240k in 1947AD Famine Year)	172 579k	146 480k	142 619k	165 350k	Net 1941-45 drop of -29 960k (-17,4%); 1,0-1,5M died in 1946-47 famine; spliced at 165 350k (1953AD) with post-Stalin epoch

Table 8. Great Patriotic War occupation losses, the Holocaust, Leningrad siege mortality, and the 1946AD - 1947AD famine across the forty-five regions.

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